

FROM DU TO JAMIA,
CITY'S HOSTEL CRUNCH **P3**



KHARGE PURIFICATION ROW:
UTTARAKHAND POLICE FILE FIR **P9**

BIPASHA DISMISSES
FACING TROLLING **P14**



SATYA NIKETAN COLLAPSE
SC to hear plea for
safety audit of Delhi
PGs on September 10

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, September 8

The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to hear on September 10 a plea seeking a time-bound safety inspection and audit of paying guest (PG) accommodations, private hostels and similar student housing in and around colleges and universities across Delhi, following the Satya Niketan building collapse that killed seven people. The court said the matter may be transferred from the Delhi High Court if necessary, noting that the issues overlap with a case before it concerning unsafe and unauthorised construction across India.

A bench of Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and R Mahadevan said the issues raised were "serious". Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Delhi government, described the incident as "most unfortunate" and said, "Our heart goes out to the children and the parents."

Senior advocate Ajit Sinha, amicus curiae in the Supreme Court case, said he had inspected the collapse site with an IIT professor and

CONTINUED ON P4

TALKS TO FOCUS ON SU-57, TRADE AND UKRAINE

Modi and Putin to hold bilateral talks on Sept 11 before BRICS

Russia backs India's call for peace; pledges to return Indians serving in Russian military

VINAY KUMAR
New Delhi, September 8

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin will hold a bilateral meeting in New Delhi on Friday, September 11, ahead of the 18th BRICS Summit, with defence, energy, technology, trade and the Ukraine conflict expected to figure in their discussions, Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov said on Tuesday. The meeting will take place a day before the two-day summit begins at Bharat Mandapam on September 12.

Putin is scheduled to visit India for the summit, which will be hosted by Modi under India's BRICS chairship for 2026. Peskov said the two leaders would first take up the bilateral agenda and described their relationship as "very pragmatic", saying they can discuss sensitive issues in an open and constructive manner.

Defence cooperation is expected to be a key part of



Russian President Vladimir Putin and Prime Minister Narendra Modi talk during their meeting

FILE PHOTO

the talks. Peskov said Moscow would discuss the proposed sale of Su-57 fifth-generation fighter jets to India and is open to sharing technology linked to the aircraft. The two sides are also exploring upgrades to BrahMos missiles, while Russia remains committed to completing pending deliveries of the S-400 air defence systems.

Energy ties are also likely to receive attention. Peskov said India's Russian crude purchases were continuing at high levels, with volumes setting new records each month, although he did not provide figures. Russia and India are also looking at negotiations for India's plans to build new civil nuclear reactors.

CLOSER LOOK

- » Defence, energy, technology and trade on agenda
- » Su-57 fighter jet sale likely to figure prominently
- » Russia offers technology sharing on Su-57 aircraft
- » BrahMos missile upgrades also under discussion
- » Moscow committed to pending S-400 deliveries

» **INDIA-RUSSIA ENERGY TIES REMAIN ROBUST, KREMLIN SAYS**

India, China establish
direct military channel
in Arunachal Pradesh

Hold first-ever senior commander-level meeting in Arunachal

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, September 8

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on Tuesday confirmed that India and China have held the first-ever "Senior Highest Military Commander-Level Flag Meeting" in the Arunachal Pradesh sector. The meeting marks a new mechanism for direct communication between senior military commanders in a particularly sensitive part of the India-China border and could signal the beginning of the normalisation of structured military interactions between the two sides after years of heightened tension along the frontier.

While addressing the media, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said the two-day exercise was held in two separate sessions, with the first taking place on the Indian side at Wacha in Arunachal

KEY POINTS

- » Talks were held in Wacha and Damai
- » Wacha hosted the Indian session on September 6
- » Damai hosted the Chinese session on September 7
- » The meeting followed August 2025 SR understandings
- » It also followed August 2026 SR understandings

Pradesh on September 6 and the second on the Chinese side at Damai in China on September 7.

The meeting comes in the wake of understandings reached during the Special Representatives (SRs) dialogue and discussions under the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination (WMCC) between India and China. Direct communication between senior commanders could provide a channel

CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

Hundreds of flights cancelled at Heathrow

LONDON: More than 600 flights were cancelled across the UK on Tuesday after a technical problem hit air traffic control provider NATS, disrupting operations at major airports including Heathrow, Gatwick, Manchester and Stansted. Flight-tracking website Flight-radar24 reported at least 625 cancellations, with easyJet cancelling about 200 flights and British Airways more than 100. CONTINUED ON P4

Hockey teams set to wear blue again

NEW DELHI: India's hockey teams are returning to their traditional blue jerseys for the upcoming Asian Games following backlash over a temporary switch to saffron. The saffron kit, worn during the FIH World Cups in the Netherlands and Belgium, drew strong public criticism CONTINUED ON P4

UN map puts AP, Aksai Chin beyond India

NEW DELHI: A new United Nations world map has drawn attention in India after depicting Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin as separate regions between Indian and Chinese territorial claims, despite New Delhi's stated positions on both areas. The map was first published on July 1 during discussions linked to a UN General Assembly resolution backed CONTINUED ON P4

'NARAZ FUFA' TO 'JHOOTH KI GOONJ'
Modi targets Oppn at freight corridor completion; reaches out to Gen Z

MPOST BUREAU
Vadodara, September 8

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday laid foundation stones and inaugurated and dedicated various development projects worth more than Rs. 35,000 crore here.

The prime minister received a rousing welcome from the crowd attending the "NaMo for Viksit Bharat" event at Maharaja Sayajirao University in this city of Gujarat.

Billed as PM Modi's Gen Z outreach, the event, witnessed a special 'Y'-shaped ramp built specially for the PM to walk with young people seated armed with mobile phones in their hands around it.

Modi walked along the ramp, waving to students and professionals, as a fusion of Queen's 1977 hit 'We Will Rock You' and 'Aari Aari' from Dhurand-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi addresses the inauguration and foundation stone laying of Rs 35,000 crore development projects at an event

PTI

"AFTER 2014, INDIA BUILT 50,000 MODERN RAIL COACHES. THE PREVIOUS REGIME COULD NOT BUILD EVEN 50,000 TOILETS IN 10 YEARS"

har: The Revenge played in the background.

Later, PM Modi took a dig at the Opposition over the newly inaugurated dedicated freight corridor, saying critics would still complain like a "naraz fufa" (grumpy uncle) and manufacture grievances, while also dismissing Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's campaign against the government CONTINUED ON P4

Ladakh LG Vinai Kumar Saxena gets additional charge of J&K

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi/Leh, September 8

Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena has been given additional charge of Jammu and Kashmir during the leave of incumbent LG Manoj Sinha, the Rashtrapati Bhavan said Tuesday. Saxena will begin the assignment by administering the oath to Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati as Chief Justice of the J&K and Ladakh High Court at 11 am in Srinagar.

The arrangement marks the first time since Ladakh became a Union Territory in August 2019 that its LG will administer the oath to the high court's chief justice. Sinha, who became J&K LG on August 7, 2020, is currently in the US and addressed an IIT (BHU) alumni meet in Chicago on Monday. Justice Bhati, appointed CONTINUED ON P4

Manipuri musician's killing in Delhi sparks outrage, calls for justice

Seven men arrested, juvenile apprehended in case

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, September 8

The killing of 54-year-old Manipuri musician and music teacher Chongtham Vikram Singh in south Delhi has triggered demands for a swift and impartial investigation, while also leading to a political exchange between the Congress and BJP. Singh was allegedly beaten by a group of men after he objected to loud noise and drinking outside his home in Kilokari village late Sunday night. Seven adults have been arrested, and a 15-year-old boy has been apprehended in connection with the case.

According to police and people familiar with the incident, Singh went downstairs from his third-floor apartment at around 11.30 pm on Sunday to dispose of garbage when he noticed a group of men



People participate in a candlelight vigil at the Western Gate of Kangla condemning the killing of Manipuri musician Chongtham Vikram Singh

PTI

associated with nearby dhabas and food stalls creating a disturbance. An argument reportedly followed after he asked them to lower the noise.

Singh was then allegedly chased back into his residential building and attacked. B Ruchida Sharma, a Manipuri social

activist, said the group followed him to the third floor, where he was overpowered and beaten in the corridor before the attackers fled.

A neighbour living on the second floor recalled hearing a commotion and briefly opening her door. CONTINUED ON P4

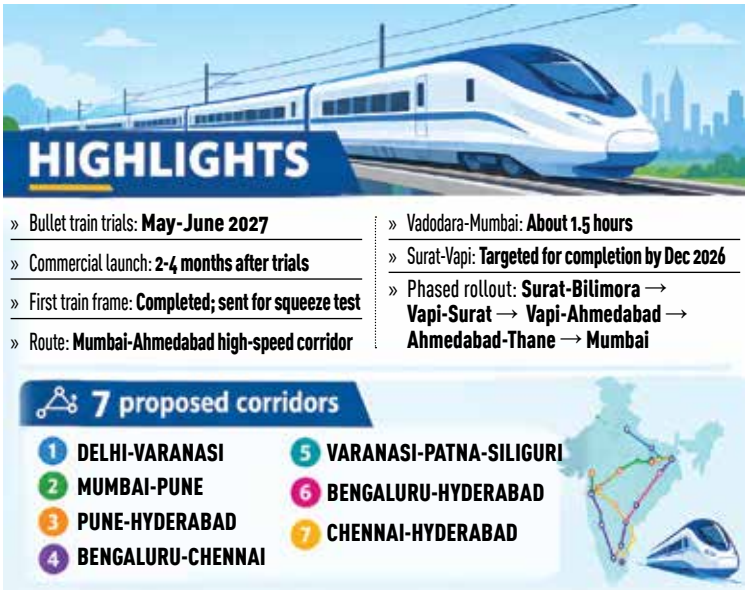
INDIA-MADE BULLET TRAIN BODY FRAME READY

Bullet train trials set for May-June 2027

MPOST BUREAU
Vadodara, September 8

India's first indigenous bullet train is expected to begin trial runs in May or June 2027, with commercial operations likely to start two to four months after testing, Union Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said on Tuesday. Speaking at the 'NaMo for Viksit Bharat' event in Vadodara, Vaishnaw said the first body frame of the high-speed train had been completed and sent for a squeeze test to assess its structural strength. The trials will be conducted on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad high-speed rail corridor, marking a major step towards bringing India's first bullet train into service.

"By May or June of next year, India's own bullet train will be on the tracks for testing. After a testing period of 2-4 months, the bullet train will be inaugurated by the Prime Minister himself," Vaishnaw said.



The minister said the project was being developed as part of the Atmanirbhar Bharat vision, with

the indigenous train expected to significantly reduce travel time. CONTINUED ON P4

NIA leaves out UAPA in chargesheet against US national, 6 Ukrainians

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 8

In a major turn in the case, the NIA on Tuesday chargesheeted US national Matthew Aaron Van Dyke and six Ukrainians only under the Immigration and Foreigners Act, leaving out the UAPA charges invoked when they were arrested in March. Van Dyke was arrested at Kolkata airport, while the Ukrainians were held at Lucknow and Delhi airports on March 13 over alleged links with ethnic armed groups and suspected mercenary activities.

The NIA said further investigation was continuing to determine their possible role in offences



Matthew Aaron Van Dyke

under the UAPA. It alleged the group entered India in December 2025, travelled to Guwahati and crossed into Myanmar through Mizoram without the mandatory Protected Area Permit. They allegedly provided training in drone warfare and related technology to ethnic armed groups. The court will hear the matter next on October 1. SEE P8

TILL SEPTEMBER 6

330+ building-related calls, 30 deaths: DFS

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 8

The Delhi Fire Service received over 330 calls related to building issues between January 1 and September 6 this year, with such incidents leaving 30 people dead and 120 injured, according to Delhi Fire Services data.

In the corresponding period last year, the DFS had received 446 calls, with building-related incidents resulting in 46 deaths or fatal incidents and 155 injuries, the data accessed by PTI showed.

A DFS official said the calls received and responded to by the department did not pertain only to major building collapses, but also included minor incidents and precautionary calls involving cracks in structures, falling bricks, roof collapses and other building-related concerns.

Despite the decline in the overall number of calls and casualties compared with last year, the city has witnessed several fatal building collapses and other major incidents this year. These include the May 30 collapse in Saidulajab that killed six people, a house collapse in Malka Ganj's Sabzi Mandi area and the collapse of a four-storey building in Karawal Nagar, both in June.

A major fire at a bed-and-breakfast establishment in Hauz Rani on June 3 also claimed 23 lives, including

CLOSER LOOK

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11 foreign nationals.

The latest major incident occurred in Satya Niketan, where a five-storey building housing a boys' paying guest accommodation near Delhi University's South Campus collapsed around 1.30 pm on September 6.

The over 27-hour rescue operation at the site concluded around 5.10 pm on Monday, with all rescue units subsequently withdrawn, according to the DFS. Twelve people were pulled out of the debris, of whom seven died and five were injured.

Multiple agencies, including the Delhi Police, DFS, National Disaster Response Force and Delhi Disaster Management Authority, were involved in the rescue operation through the night and into Monday.

Locals claimed that repair work was underway at the building when it collapsed.

Police have arrested the building owner, 81-year-old Hariram, a retired Indian Air Force sergeant, his 75-year-old wife Urmila and their 52-year-old son Mahesh in connection with the incident.

The three have been booked on charges including culpable homicide, negligence in the upkeep of a structure and endangering the safety of others. "Hariram and his son were allegedly running the PG, while Urmila was the owner of the property. Following the arrests, teams are questioning the three to ascertain the cause of the collapse and fix responsibility for the incident," a police officer said.

WITH PTI INPUTS

Noida student gets notice for participating in Jantar Mantar protest, revoked later

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Noida, September 8

A student of Gautam Buddha University (GBU), who allegedly participated in a CJP-led protest at Delhi's Jantar Mantar, was served a notice by the Greater Noida Executive Magistrate seeking a personal bond of Rs 5 lakh for maintaining peace, officials said on Tuesday, adding that the order was later revoked.

The student, Akshat Tripathi, however, denied the allegations and claimed that he had participated in the protest peacefully and was not attending university classes at the time.

The notice was issued on September 4 under Section 130 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), following proceedings initiated under Sections 126 and 135 of the law through the Assistant Commissioner of Police's court.

The notice required Tripathi to show cause why he should not be ordered to maintain peace for six months by furnishing a personal bond of Rs 5 lakh and sureties of an equal amount from two local solvent persons. A hearing was scheduled for September 5.

According to the police report submitted by Sub-Inspector Shiva Pandey of

the Ecotech-1 police station and forwarded by the station house officer, Tripathi, originally from Jhansi in Prayagraj and currently residing in the Ecotech-1 area, is a student of GBU.

The report alleged that Tripathi was encouraging other university students to participate in a protest proposed by a political party and was circulating misleading and anti-government narratives.

Police claimed his activities had created a tense atmosphere on the university campus and raised the possibility of altercations and a breach of public order.

However, on Tuesday, police at Ecotech police station said the notice had been revoked on September 4 itself after the matter came to their attention, and the concerned authorities were informed accordingly.

In a video circulated on social media, Tripathi rejected the allegations and said he had participated in the protest peacefully. He claimed he was not attending university classes at the time as the institution had remained closed for nearly three months.

Tripathi also claimed that he was injured during Delhi Police action when protesters were march-

ing towards Parliament on July 20. The Students' Federation of India (SFI) condemned the action, describing it as "repressive" and criticising the Uttar Pradesh government and police.

Reacting to the matter on X, CJP co-convenor Saurav Das said, "Has the DM Gautam Buddh Nagar (Medha Roopam) not read the historic September 1 order of the Supreme Court? All protesters have a permanent blanket immunity from any legal action for their participation in CJP protests. Akshat Tripathi need not execute bail bond of 5 lakh rupees."

28-year-old man shot dead in N-W Delhi's Adarsh Nagar

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 8

A 28-year-old man was shot dead in the early hours of Tuesday in north-west Delhi's Adarsh Nagar, with police suspecting the attack may be linked to an earlier murder, an official said.

The deceased, identified as Alam, sustained multiple gunshot injuries near a shop at New Sabzi Mandi in the TPT Nagar area at 1:45 am, he said.

According to preliminary information, Alam was allegedly shot eight to ten times. He was rushed to the Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial Hospital, where doctors declared him brought dead.

After being alerted about the incident, a police team reached the spot where they found blood stains and empty cartridges, the officer said.

The crime team also inspected the scene and collected evidence as part of the investigation.

Police are probing whether the killing was carried out as an act of revenge for an earlier murder in the area. Sources also said there were allegations that prostitution had been operating in the locality for several years and that the previous killing may have been connected to it. Police are verifying these claims as part of the investigation.

Playing outside home, 2-yr-old run over by car

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
Gurugram, September 8

A two-year-old girl was killed after being run over by a speeding car while playing with her elder sister outside her home in Gurugram's Sector 6 on Monday night.

The police were alerted about the incident through a PCR call received at the sector 5 Police Station.

The accused driver, a 30-year-old private firm employee and local resident was arrested on Tuesday and the vehicle involved in the accident was seized.

The victim, identified as a minor playing outside her house with her elder sister Dhviya at around 9 pm when the incident occurred.

According to police, the entire accident was captured by CCTV cameras installed in the neighbourhood.

The footage showed the two sisters playing outside their house while their mother stood a few steps away, speaking to someone.

At around 9:02 pm, a car approached the corner house and took a sharp right turn. During the manoeuvre, the vehicle ran over Adrija, while her elder sister managed to move away and escape being hit.

Adrija's mother immediately picked up the toddler and found her unresponsive. The family rushed her to a private hospital in Palam Vihar, where doctors declared her dead on

arrival. The girl's father, Virendra Tiwari, said the driver also got out of the car and tried to help after the incident.

Tiwari, an engineer with a US based travel technology company, alleged that the driver was aware that children were present in the area.

According to Tiwari, the driver had passed the same spot around five minutes earlier. He said his wife had managed to pull both daughters away from the road at that time, but the driver allegedly returned at high speed and hit Adrija while taking the turn.

Tiwari said he immediately informed the police control room following the accident. He also alleged that police personnel who arrived at the spot initially tried to convince the family that the incident was unintentional.

Police said the family originally belonged to Prayagraj in Uttar Pradesh and had been residing in Gurugram for several years.

Sandeep Turan, public relations officer of Gurugram Police, said an FIR was registered at Sector 5 police station under Sections 106 and 281 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, pertaining to causing death by negligence and rash driving.

The accused told police that he could not see the children because it was dark, leading to the accident. Further investigation is underway.

Briefs

DDA to offer 544 addl flats in Narela

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) will offer 544 additional newly constructed flats in Pocket 11, Sector A1-A4, Narela, under the DDA Karmajeevi Awaas Yojana 2026, with booking scheduled to begin on September 14 at 12 noon. The decision comes after an encouraging response to the scheme, with more than 60 per cent of the flats on offer sold within less than a month of the start of booking. The additional offering includes 256 1-BHK flats in Tower Z and 288 2-BHK flats in Towers N and P.

Fbd ranks 14th in nat'l Clean Air Survey

FARIDABAD: Faridabad has secured the 14th rank in the national Clean Air Survey, Haryana Urban Local Bodies and Revenue Minister Vipul Goel said on Tuesday. According to an official statement, Goel said the city's ranking had improved consistently over the past four years, from 47th in 2023 to 21st in 2024, 19th in 2025 and 14th in 2026. He attributed the improvement to the cooperation of residents and various measures undertaken by the Municipal Corporation of Faridabad.

NDMC ramps up BRICS preparations

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 8

With just four days left for the 18th BRICS Summit, the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) has moved into an intensified phase of preparations, running a round-the-clock command centre, deploying an expanded night sanitation force and coordinating a fresh inter-agency inspection of key routes leading to the venue.

An Integrated Command & Control Centre (ICCC), operational out of Palika Kendra since September 5 and functioning till September 14, is monitoring civic services through CCTV



surveillance, field reports and inspections by senior officers, with nodal officers from departments such as civil engineering, horticulture, public health, enforcement, transport and fire safety stationed in shifts, officials said.

Dedicated 24x7 phone lines have been activated at the centre to help departments and security agencies, including Delhi Police, Traffic Police and CPWD, coordinate seamlessly through the summit period, they said.

Speaker Vijender Gupta asks DU students to engage in democracy

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 8

Calling on young people to move beyond being spectators of politics, Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta on Tuesday urged Delhi University students to actively participate in democracy, public affairs and nation-building, saying their ideas and energy were crucial to building a "Viksit Bharat".

Gupta was interacting with students from Rajdhani College, Shyama Prasad Mukherjee College, Law Centre-I and Shivaji College during the Delhi Assembly's Youth Outreach Programme. The students visited the historic Assembly complex and discussed parliamentary functioning, democratic participation and the Speaker's role.

"Do not watch politics from a distance; step forward, participate and contribute to building a Viksit

Bharat," Gupta told the students. Responding to a question about his transition from Leader of Opposition to Speaker, Gupta said his earlier experience had shaped his approach to conducting House proceedings. He said every legislator, irrespective of political affiliation, should receive a fair opportunity to express their views within parliamentary rules and procedures.

"From Leader of Opposition to Speaker, my experiences shaped my commitment to give every member a fair chance to speak," Gupta said.

The Speaker also highlighted the use of timers on display screens inside the Assembly chamber to improve discipline and transparency during debates. The system allows members to monitor their allotted speaking time and helps proceedings remain organised and time-bound. During the visit, students

were taken on a guided tour of the Assembly complex and briefed about its historical association with the Central Legislative Assembly and prominent parliamentary figures and events.

They were also introduced to the Assembly's commemorative coffee-table book, Ek Shatabdi Yatra, which documents its century-long institutional journey. The programme concluded with a visit to the main Assembly chamber, giving students an opportunity to see first-hand the setting where legislative debates and proceedings are conducted.

Gupta urged the students to remain connected with democratic institutions and develop an informed understanding of governance and public affairs, stressing that youth participation was essential for strengthening democratic institutions and contributing to nation-building.

Luxury hotels face room crunch, tariffs surge around event dates

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 8

Luxury hotels in Delhi are seeing a sharp room crunch and a steep rise in tariffs ahead of the BRICS Summit, with several marquee properties showing no availability around the September 12-13 event or quoting rates running into six figures per night.

A check of hotel booking platforms showed no availability on September 11-12 at Taj Mahal and The Oberoi in New Delhi, while no rooms were available at Taj Palace in the city for September 10-12. The Leela Palace, New Delhi, was not accepting bookings for September 10-12.

Rooms available for September 10-13 at properties such as the ITC Maurya, New Delhi, were

HIGHLIGHTS

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commanding exceptionally high tariffs, with the starting price for night accommodation running into over Rs 2.3 lakh.

K B Kachru, President, Hotel Association of India (HAI) and Chairman - South Asia, Radisson Hotel Group, told PTI, "India is commanding global attention at a defining moment

– as the nation prepares to host marquee international events and cements its position as a premier MICE destination, the world is watching how we scale to meet our tourism targets.

"The BRICS Summit alone will put considerable focus on room inventory and that spotlight is exposing a hard truth: our hospitality infrastructure has not kept pace with our tourism ambition," he added.

Kachru highlighted that India currently has only about 200,000-220,000 branded hotel rooms, and for a country of our size and aspiration, that is starkly inadequate.

The two-day geopolitical event is effectively compressing demand across several days, as delegates and other visitors arrive

ahead of the Summit and extend their stays, putting additional pressure on room inventory in central Delhi.

This could leave tourists, business travellers and families with pre-planned trips to the national capital facing substantially higher accommodation costs, forcing them to either pay a premium for marquee properties, look for hotels farther from central Delhi, alter their travel dates or opt for lower-priced accommodation.

The BRICS Summit comes at a time when Indian hotels are looking to events-led travel and domestic demand to offset a challenging period for international travel amid geopolitical tensions, including the West Asia conflict.

INJURED TO GET Rs 5L AID

Fallout: PG checks ordered, CM meets injured at AIIMS

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 8

Days after the Satya Niketan building collapse that claimed seven lives, the Delhi government has begun a wider crackdown on unsafe student accommodation, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta ordering comprehensive safety checks of PG hostels across the city and directing the demolition of dilapidated structures declared unsafe.

Gupta on Tuesday visited the AIIMS Trauma Centre and met the injured students and their families. She took an update from doctors on the condition of those undergoing treatment and assured the families that the government would bear the entire cost of their treatment.



“SAVING THE LIVES OF THE CHILDREN IS THE GOVT’S TOP PRIORITY. NO SHORTCOMING WILL BE ALLOWED IN THEIR TREATMENT — CM

be based on the ongoing investigation.

The government has simultaneously widened its focus from the collapsed structure to PG accommodations across Delhi. The Municipal Corporation has been directed to inspect all PG hostels under its jurisdiction and submit detailed reports.

The inspections will cover building safety, permissions, Fire Safety NOCs, structural stability certificates and compliance with other prescribed norms.

Government fast-tracks industrial, startup policies

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 8

Delhi is moving to overhaul its industrial and startup ecosystem, with the government stepping up work on the proposed Delhi Industrial Policy 2026-2036 and Delhi Startup Policy 2026-2031, while pushing faster implementation of single-window clearances, export promotion and MSME reforms.

Industries Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa reviewed the progress of key schemes and projects of the Industries Department on Tuesday and directed officials to adhere to fixed timelines and remove delays.

“It is important that every scheme, programme

and project moves forward according to clearly defined timelines. We have directed the concerned officers to closely monitor progress and ensure that there are no avoidable delays,” Sirsa said. “Government initiatives must translate into visible benefits for citizens, entrepreneurs, investors, startups, MSMEs and industrial stakeholders at the earliest.”

The proposed industrial policy will focus on clean and sustainable industries and identify sectors such as frontier technologies, Global Capability Centres, data centres, healthcare, urban logistics, circular economy, green transition and industry-linked skilling.

Bomb threats at Delhi Assembly, Civic Centre

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 8

The Delhi Assembly and the Civic Centre received bomb threats via email on Tuesday, triggering security checks at both premises, with no suspicious object found during searches, police said.

The Delhi Assembly received the email around 8:30 am, following which security agencies were alerted and necessary checks were initiated, they said. Sources said Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta received the email. Separately, Civic

Centre security authorities also received an email around 10 am, and it was subsequently shared with the Delhi Police, officials said. On receiving the information, personnel from Kamla Market police station, local police and security agencies at the Civic Centre searched the premises.

The Bomb Disposal Squad was also informed through the police control room to conduct an anti-sabotage check (ASC), officials said, adding that during the search, no suspicious object or substance was found.

Senior officials at the zonal level will supervise the exercise.

The move comes amid growing concerns over the safety of students living in privately operated PGs and rented accommodation, particularly around major university hubs where hostel capacity remains limited.

At Satya Niketan, the government has also ordered the demolition of dilapidated buildings near the collapse site that have been declared unsafe. The Chief Minister expressed concern over the safety of workers carrying out construction-related activities in the area and directed that all such work be stopped until safety conditions are ensured.

Delhi Fire Service personnel are also removing students’ belongings from the affected building and bringing them out safely.

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AISF marches in DU, seeks compensation for victims

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 8

The All India Students’ Federation (AISF) on Tuesday organised a march in Delhi University’s North Campus, demanding compensation for students affected by the Satya Niketan building collapse and adequate hostel facilities for all DU students.

More than 30 students participated in the march, which began at the Arts Faculty and proceeded towards the office of the Vice-Chancellor. AISF General Secretary Dinesh Sreerangaraj and national president Viraa Devang also took part in the demonstration. A memorandum listing the students’ demands was submitted to the Vice-Chan-

7 deaths, 1 policy pushed into fast-forward

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 8

The Satya Niketan building collapse has pushed Delhi’s long-pending student housing reforms into fast-forward mode, with the government now promising a comprehensive policy to regulate paying guest (PG) accommodations within the next one to two months. The proposed framework is expected to bring PGs under mandatory licensing, introduce zone-wise rent bands and make structural and fire safety audits compulsory.

Delhi Urban Develop-

ment Minister Ashish Sood made the announcement on Tuesday after meeting a delegation of university students, including NSS volunteers, living in PG facilities and rented accommodation at the Delhi Secretariat. The interaction was convened following the Satya Niketan incident to seek first-hand feedback on safety and living conditions in student housing.

“The Urban Development department was already working on a PG policy, and as I shared with you earlier, on implementing the Justice Gauba Committee report for

coaching institutes,” Sood said. “But this tragic incident has forced us to speed up the implementation of the Gauba Committee report and frame a policy that addresses everyone’s concerns.”

Students flagged several problems, including lack of transparency over rents and facilities, landlords not honouring rental agreements, arbitrary electricity charges and inadequate safety checks. They demanded a dedicated portal where PG operators would disclose rents, meal plans, amenities and structural safety details before students take

accommodation. Responding to the concerns, Sood said the government was examining ways to make tenancy agreements legally enforceable.

“Since agreements exist between two private individuals, the government is looking into a legal methodology to make these tenancy deeds legally binding,” he said.

The proposed Paying Guest Accommodation Regulation and Safety Bill, 2026 is expected to mandate PG operating licences, zone-wise rent bands, structural and fire safety certifications and regu-

lar inspections. A central GovPG portal is also being planned to provide students with information on rents, amenities and safety compliance.

The government is simultaneously looking at expanding hostel capacity. Universities and institutions could be allowed higher Floor Area Ratio (FAR) to facilitate additional hostel construction. Vacant government properties, including unused buildings in Narela, are also being examined for conversion into student hostels, with direct bus connectivity proposed.

MCD turns up heat on unsafe buildings

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 8

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has intensified inspections of dangerous and dilapidated buildings as well as unauthorised constructions across the city, directing its zonal officials to identify structures that could pose a threat to public safety and take action under the law.

Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi and MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar have directed all Zonal Deputy Commissioners to conduct comprehensive surveys of buildings in their respective jurisdictions and categorise them according to their structural condition and level of risk. Structures posing an immediate threat to life are to be dealt with on priority, including through sealing or demolition wherever warranted.

The directions were issued during a meeting chaired by Khirwar with the Zonal Deputy Commissioners. The officials were asked to distinguish between buildings requiring major or minor repairs and those that could pose an imminent danger to

occupants and the public.

The civic body has also ordered action against illegal constructions and structural violations that compromise safety. The Mayor said Deputy Commissioners had been directed to identify cases of unauthorised construction and take action in accordance with the applicable building bye-laws. The MCD will also inspect PG accommodations, schools, hotels and healthcare facilities to verify whether mandatory approvals, permissions and other documents are in place. Meanwhile, Deputy Mayor Monika Pant, during an inspection of Ghazipur Ward-194 in east Delhi, directed officials to take time-bound action against encroachments, illegal dairies and stray animals. Pant inspected areas including Amma Block near Ashirwad Apartment, G.D. Colony A-Block and GBB Point, and interacted with residents about civic issues. She directed officials to clear encroachments from public spaces and address sanitation problems arising from illegal dairies, including improper disposal of cow dung and disruption of drainage.

‘Don’t send your kids to Delhi’

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 8

They sent their children to Delhi with dreams of a better education and a brighter future that their small towns could not offer. But after a boys’ hostel collapsed in Satya Niketan, the families of the victims are returning home with a bitter message for anyone still dreaming the same dream: Don’t send your kids to Delhi.

The families of the students who died in the collapse had struggled to put them through college in the national capital. Sunday’s collapse of the decades-old building housing a boys’ paying guest accommodation has not only claimed lives and shattered families but also left them questioning whether the city was worth the risk.

For Bhupendra Jaj, who decided to donate his son Ankit’s one eye after the other got damaged in the tragic incident, Delhi has been a profound disappointment.

“We have become completely disappointed. I just want to say to everyone, don’t send your kids to Delhi,” Bhupendra said.

The family of five had endured considerable hardship to provide Ankit with a good education, Jaj said. He recalled that shortly after the building collapsed, one of his son’s friends called the family around 3 pm to ask about him and warned them not to let him return to the area if he was still in Dewas – their hometown in Madhya Pradesh.

“We told him that he had already left for Delhi and had reached there in the morning. We had a lot of trouble just finding his body. Nobody was ready to tell us anything. They showed only two photographs to us when there were more bodies,” Jaj said.

The family has demanded a thorough investigation into the collapse.



1 HOSTEL BED, 28 STUDENTS From DU to Jamia, city’s hostel crunch

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 8

One hostel bed for roughly every 28 students, that is the stark arithmetic behind Delhi’s student housing crisis, now under the spotlight after the Satya Niketan building collapse claimed seven lives. The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) has also stepped in, directing the Delhi government and UGC to work with Delhi University (DU) on expanding hostel capacity. But the shortage is not unique to DU, students at other major universities, including Jamia Millia Islamia, too face limited hostel availability, leaving many dependent on private PGs and rented flats where concerns over ageing buildings, fire safety and basic infrastructure are increasingly being raised. DU’s 2024-25 annual report records more than 2.5 lakh students enrolled in conventional programmes, while more than half of its students come from outside Delhi. Against this massive student population, the university’s hostel capacity is estimated at only around 9,000 beds.

In other words, even if all these beds were available to students without category or course restrictions, there would be only about one hostel bed for every 28 students based on the total conventional enrolment. The gap becomes particularly significant for the large outstation student population.

The shortage also sits uneasily with Section 33 of the Delhi University Act,

NHRC SEEKS COMPREHENSIVE PLAN TO EXPAND DU HOSTELS AFTER SATYA NIKETAN TRAGEDY

1922, which provides that students should reside in a college or hall, or under conditions prescribed by university ordinances, barring those pursuing correspondence courses.

Yet the limited hostel infrastructure means thousands have to find accommodation outside university campuses. Several DU hostels are also designated for specific categories or programmes, further narrowing access for the wider student population.

The NHRC has now asked authorities to prepare a specific, action-oriented plan for increasing accommodation. Importantly, its direction is not limited to building new hostels. It has asked officials to examine expansion, renovation, upgradation and augmentation of existing facilities, alongside the requirement for new hostels.

While, the same pressure is visible around other universities. Students at Jamia Millia Islamia and those living in neighbourhoods such as Batla House and Tughlaqabad have raised concerns about dependence on private housing. Many live in four- and five-storey buildings, some with narrow access lanes and inadequate fire-safety arrangements.

Form 8 allows displaced voters to retain registration

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 8

Residents whose homes were demolished during recent anti-encroachment drives will not have to lose their place on Delhi’s electoral rolls merely because they have shifted, with the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) office clarifying that such electors can use Form 8 to update their address and retain their voter registration.

The clarification came in response to a representation by the Voter Adhikar Manch amid the ongoing Special Intensive Revision



(SIR) of electoral rolls. The CEO office said existing Election Commission rules require enumeration forms to be delivered to electors found at their registered addresses.

Under Section 19 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, an elector must be an “Ordinary Resident” of the constituency. Those who have shifted can apply through Form 8 for

transfer of their electoral registration to their new address.

“If a person has ceased to Ordinary Resident of the constituency for any reason, he/she may apply for shifting of address in Form-8,” the CEO office said.

The office also clarified that a voter’s name is not automatically deleted from the old address merely because the person has shifted. The deletion from the previous address follows after the elector’s name is added at the new location.

The clarification assumes significance after

around 47.5 lakh electors were left out of the draft electoral rolls published on August 31. These voters were categorised during the enumeration exercise as Absent, Shifted, Dead or Duplicate (ASDD), among other reasons.

The CEO office said BLOs had shared ASDD lists with booth-level agents of recognised political parties during the enumeration process, while discrepancies brought to their notice were examined and corrected by Electoral Registration Officers.

Electors whose names are missing from the draft

roll can file Form 6 during the claims and objections period, which runs until September 30. Those seeking address changes can submit Form 8 along with the required declaration and supporting documents.

The CEO office reiterated that electoral roll revision is a continuous process and names can be added, deleted or modified through Forms 6, 7 and 8.

It said, “no eligible citizen is left out while no ineligible person is included in the Electoral Roll,” and added that the final electoral roll is scheduled to be published on November 4.

PRONOUNCES HIS 23RD CAPITAL PUNISHMENT VERDICT IN 4 MONTHS

‘Prefer death to being called coward,’ says judge Diwakar

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Muzaffarnagar, September 8

Additional District and Sessions Judge Ravi Kumar Diwakar, while pronouncing his 23rd capital punishment in the last four months in a dowry death case on Monday,

said in his verdict that he would prefer death to being called a “coward judge”.

In his judgment awarding the death penalty to a man who burnt his wife over dowry demands, the fast-track judge asserted that he would not dis-

charge his judicial duties “under pressure from mafias, gangsters or criminals”.

Diwakar observed that his parents had taught him to fear God and no one else, and that if he performed his judicial duties out of fear of

strongmen, mafias, gangsters or criminals, public faith in the judiciary would erode.

In his judgment, Diwakar said he would prefer death to being known as a coward judge and would continue serving as long as he could follow his

principles.

The judge also stated that he had been receiving threats from mafias and criminals, and alleged that about 100 serious cases had been withdrawn from his court, allegedly to benefit mafias and criminals.

It is learnt that Diwakar has sought protection from senior officers, alleging that his security cover in Muzaffarnagar has been reduced.

In the case decided on Monday, Diwakar’s court convicted the man, Nadeem, under Sections

302 and 504 of the Indian Penal Code and imposed a fine of Rs 1 lakh, according to government counsel Kuldeep Kumar.

The case related to Nadeem allegedly setting ablaze his wife Shehzadi (23) in Shahpur town on July 23, 2018, over dowry

demands.

Shehzadi was taken to Delhi’s Safdarjung Hospital in a serious condition, where she later died. In her statement recorded before her death, Shehzadi alleged that Nadeem set her on fire, the government counsel said.

From page 1

SC to hear plea for safety audit

MCD officials and submitted a status report. He sought permission for the court-appointed committee to extend inspections beyond Lajpat Nagar, Malviya Nagar and Saket.

The proposed audit would examine sanctioned building plans, actual construction and floor count, basement alterations, land use, structural safety, fire compliance, entry and exit routes, and dangerous conditions.

The five-storey building, used as the Hostel Daze boys’ PG, collapsed around 1.15 pm on September 6. Seven people died and five were injured after a rescue operation lasting more than 27 hours. The property covered about 55 square yards and had a basement and four floors above the ground.

Police have apprehended labour contractor Sanoj from Kasganj, Uttar Pradesh, for questioning over construction and repair work. Hari-ram, his wife Urmila and their son Mahesh have also been arrested. Mahesh allegedly told investigators he handled maintenance for his parents.

Police said basement repairs had been underway for eight to 10 days amid accumulated water and waste, while work was also being carried out on the ground floor for an alleged commercial extension. The FIR alleges additional construction placed pressure on the old structure.

The Delhi High Court had ordered a high-level MCD inquiry on Monday and said authorities could not evade responsibility. Five MCD officials have been suspended. The Supreme Court was also told that a similar Satya Niketan building collapse in April 2022 killed two people and injured four.

Modi and Putin

He also welcomed Indian investments and business expansion in Russia, while saying Russian companies were keen to increase their presence in India.

Peskov also criticised a proposed US measure seeking tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries importing Russian crude. Describing the proposal as “illegal, unfair and unexpected”, he said Russia would continue to pursue trade arrangements using national currencies. He said around 90 per cent of Russia’s transactions with BRICS countries are now carried out in their national currencies.

The Ukraine conflict will also be discussed during Modi and Putin’s meeting. Peskov said Russia welcomed New Delhi’s willingness to contribute to efforts for a peaceful settlement and said Moscow’s position broadly corresponded with India’s approach of resolving the conflict through dialogue and diplomacy.

“We welcome the willingness of the Indian side to contribute,” Peskov said, while also welcoming US President Donald Trump’s efforts to find a resolution.

Modi has repeatedly called for an end to the fighting. During his recent meeting with Putin on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Bishkek, he said, “We must move from endless war towards the end of war.” He said India supported

all efforts for peace and would continue to do so.

PM Modi and Putin most recently met on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan. It was their first face-to-face meeting since the annual India-Russia Summit in New Delhi last December.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar also recently travelled to Kyiv, where he said India was prepared to contribute to efforts aimed at bringing peace. MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said New Delhi remained in contact with both Russia and Ukraine and was examining ideas that could help bring about a cessation of the conflict.

The two sides are also working on the return of Indian citizens associated with the Russian military. Peskov said Russia was identifying Indians still on the battlefield and preparing a list so they could return home. Jaiswal said more than two dozen Indians are employed with the Russian military. Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri had earlier said about 51 Indians working with the Russian military had died.

The BRICS summit will bring together the grouping’s 11 full members: Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa and the UAE. Indonesia became a full member in 2025. Ten partner countries, including Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan and Vietnam, are also part of the wider BRICS framework.

India’s 2026 chairship theme is “Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability”, with the agenda covering trade, agriculture, healthcare, energy, digital technology, startups, climate action, urban development and cultural exchanges. Chinese President Xi Jinping is expected to attend the summit, which would mark his first India visit since his 2019 informal meeting with Modi in Mamallapuram.

India, China establish

to address incidents and patrol-related disagreements at an early stage and prevent them from escalating into larger confrontations.

Responding to questions, Jaiswal confirmed that the meeting was held pursuant to understandings reached between the Special Representatives of the two countries in August 2025 and August 2026, followed by further discussions at WMCC meetings held in Beijing and New Delhi in May and August 2026.

“Pursuant to the understandings that have been reached between the Special Representatives of India and China in August 2025 and August 2026, and further discussions at the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination meetings held in Beijing and New Delhi in May and August 2026, the first Senior Highest Military Commander-Level Flag Meeting was held in Wacha in India and Damai in China on September 6 and September 7 respectively,” Jaiswal said.

He further said that a similar framework already exists in the western sector, indicating that the latest development expands structured military-to-military communication to another sensitive area along the Line of Actual Control (LAC).

The development comes amid reports of a belligerent

military stance by Chinese forces in the Upper Subansiri district of Arunachal Pradesh. In this context, a direct communication channel between military commanders could allow both sides to address any misunderstanding or incident at an early stage.

Jaiswal also said that the overall relationship between India and China was moving in the right direction. The latest military engagement follows the SR dialogue held in Beijing, where Indian National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi, who serve as their countries’ representatives on the boundary issue, discussed matters concerning the India-China boundary and the need to maintain peace and tranquillity in border areas.

The SR process, introduced in 2003, was established to seek a comprehensive solution to the India-China boundary issue. The land boundary between India and China stretches 3,488 km and remains unresolved despite numerous rounds of negotiations.

For India, maintaining peace and tranquillity in the border areas remains a key priority in improving relations with China. During the SR dialogue, the Indian side stressed the importance of maintaining peace and tranquillity along the border as a prerequisite for improving bilateral relations. India has consistently maintained that the normalisation of bilateral relations cannot be separated from developments along the LAC.

The establishment of the military channel in the eastern sector gives India and China another mechanism to track and handle developments on the ground. Much of the military and diplomatic focus since the Galwan Valley clash in 2020 has been on eastern Ladakh, where several rounds of disengagement talks have taken place. The latest mechanism indicates that structured military communication is now being extended to other sensitive areas along the LAC.

In addition to diplomatic engagement, the meeting brings a direct military-to-military component into the broader framework dealing with the boundary issue. Regularised communication between commanders could allow potential problems to be discussed before they develop into a crisis, rather than opening communication only after an incident has already escalated.

The timing of the meeting is also significant, coming just days before the planned visit of Chinese President Xi Jinping to New Delhi for the BRICS summit. Xi is expected to arrive in the national capital on Saturday.

Manipuri musician’s

“I saw some people running behind a person. I had no idea who they were, as it was dark outside. They were abusing him and, due to fear and the late hour, I closed my door,” she said.

The neighbour described Singh as “very humble” and soft-spoken, saying he had lived in the locality for around eight to nine years. She also said the noise outside had made her feel unsafe.

Delhi Police received a PCR call about the assault at 1.38 am on Monday. Singh’s 20-year-old son, Yaiphaba, a law student, took him to Holy Family Hospital in Okhla, where he later died from his injuries at around

7am, according to people familiar with the case.

Police said CCTV footage, technical surveillance and local intelligence helped identify and trace those allegedly involved. The arrested men are Bharat Kumar, 19, Pramod, 26, Ramzan Khan, 22, Vijay, 36, Deepanshu, 21, Mohan Vishwakarma, 32, and Mannu, 26. Four allegedly worked as delivery workers, two as packaging workers and Mannu at a pizza kiosk, with all linked to nearby dhabas or food outlets.

A case has been registered under Sections 103(2) and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. Police are also examining whether there was any racist motive behind the attack.

Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said Delhi Police had assured him that a chargesheet would be filed within eight to nine days. He said he was personally monitoring the investigation and called for the “strictest possible” punishment for those responsible.

Rijiju said the accused were from states including Jharkhand, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Bihar. He also said arrangements had been made to take Singh’s body to Imphal on Wednesday.

Singh’s family, meanwhile, appealed for justice rather than revenge. Addressing a press conference at Manipur Bhawan, his wife Joshna Chongtham said, “We are not seeking revenge. We are seeking justice.” She said the family wanted accountability and an impartial investigation while asking that Singh’s memory and dignity be respected.

Singh had lived in the Kilokari area for more than two decades and had spent about 17 years working as a private music teacher in Delhi. His musical career began in Manipur, where he played with Ultra Vires before joining the legendary rock band Phoenix in the early 1980s. He later performed with Eastern Dark and worked with singer Mame Khan for about a decade. He was also associated with Coke Studio and taught Hindustani music, rock and roll and jazz.

The killing has also raised concern among members of Delhi’s northeastern community. The Northeast India Forum Against Racism alleged that the case reflected racial discrimination, while the North East Students Society, Delhi University, described Singh as a respected Manipuri musician and sought a swift and fair probe.

Residents and community members held a candlelight march in Kilokari on Monday evening, with nearly 100 people participating and demanding action against those responsible.

The killing drew sharp political reactions. Congress leader Rahul Gandhi asked why families from the Northeast in Delhi were left wondering about their safety, while party president Mallikarjun Kharge said the incident reflected lawlessness in the capital. Priyanka Gandhi Vadra called the killing a national shame and demanded swift action. The BJP hit back, with spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia questioning Congress over past remarks by Sam Pitroda about people from the Northeast. Rijiju said the tragedy should not be turned into a political matter, adding that every Indian life is precious.

Ladakh LG Vinai Kumar

on September 5, will succeed Acting Chief Justice San-

jeev Kumar. The Collegium recommended his name on August 31.

Meanwhile, a permanent high court bench in Ladakh took effect on September 5 under a regulation promulgated on August 27.

Modi targets

as “jhooth ki goonj” (echo of lies).

Speaking at the inauguration of three key sections of the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor, connecting Jawaharlal Nehru Port in Navi Mumbai with Dadri in Uttar Pradesh, and marking the project’s completion, Modi praised his administration’s pace of execution and called the former Congress-led UPA regime’s working speed sluggish.

The “jhooth ki goonj” jibe was aimed to mock the “Chhatron Ki Goonj” student dialogue campaign launched by the Congress. Through the campaign, the Congress is trying to corner the BJP on issues such as exam question paper leaks, costly education, irregularities in government recruitment and unemployment.

Modi remarked that opponents would always find fault with major infrastructure milestones such as the newly inaugurated freight corridor.

A double-stack container freight train, where containers are stacked one atop the other, was recently operated from the JNPT port in Mumbai to Vadodara. With that train’s operation, cargo volume equivalent to over 250 trucks was transported between the two cities in a single trip, Modi said.

Modi pointed to rapid modernisation under his decade-long tenure compared to the previous administration’s shortcomings.

“After 2014, India built 50,000 modern rail coaches. The previous regime could not build even 50,000 toilets in 10 years,” he said, reiterating that the nation’s youth would continue to champion reality over political rhetoric.

The PM said the youth could see how focused the government was on working across sectors, including solar, wind, hydro and nuclear energy. Describing the dedicated railway freight corridor as the life-line of a rapidly developing nation, he noted that India’s economic transformation was accelerating due to the modern freight structure.

Modi said that the Eastern and Western Freight Corridors are now emerging as the main backbone of the nation’s trade and commercial activities. He said the 2,800-km Dedicated Freight Corridor serves as a testament to how the country’s work culture has been fundamentally transformed over the past 12 years.

India is scripting a new saga of manufacturing, spanning “chips to ships”, with components, final products and the supply chain for self-reliance being set up in the country, Modi said.

A 100-km journey that earlier took 6.5 hours for a freight train can now be covered in less than half the time, while a 30-hour journey by truck can be completed in 10-12 hours on the Dedicated Freight Corridor, the PM noted.

Rail connectivity was also reaching parts of the country where it had been absent for decades, with tribal areas in Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra being connected through these projects, he said.

The railway budget this year stood at Rs 2.75 lakh crore, sev-

eral times higher than it was 12 years ago, and railway modernisation was creating thousands of jobs, Modi said.

Rakesh Mehta

Delhi government and also served as commissioner of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD). He was associated with the execution of several major transport, power and civic infrastructure projects in the capital.

Mehta was cremated at the Lodhi Road crematorium on Monday.

Bullet train

A journey from Vadodara to Mumbai will take about one and a half hours, he said.

Construction on the corridor is progressing in stages. Vaishnaw said the Surat-Vapi section is expected to be completed by December 2026. The service is planned to open in phases, beginning with the Surat-Bilimora section, followed by the Vapi-Surat stretch. The Vapi-Ahmedabad section is planned as the third phase, while the Ahmedabad-Thane section will be commissioned later. The Mumbai leg will follow the completion of the Thane stretch, allowing the full Ahmedabad-Mumbai service to operate.

Vaishnaw also outlined wider changes underway in Indian Railways, saying the government was modernising operational systems, reservation facilities and construction practices. “We are reforming and modernising everything, from operating systems and reservation systems to old construction protocols,” he said.

The railway modernisation programme also includes new freight wagon designs, including a specialised wagon for transporting salt, and cargo trains incorporating Vande Bharat technology.

The minister cited several infrastructure projects completed in recent years, including the Chenab Bridge and the railway connection to Mizoram. He said 280 railway stations had been redeveloped, while 36,000 km of new railway tracks had been developed across the country.

Vaishnaw said the pace of railway infrastructure work had increased despite disruptions caused by the Covid-19 pandemic. He noted that the first section of the high-speed rail project was completed in 2020, after which work on subsequent sections accelerated.

Beyond the Mumbai-Ahmedabad corridor, the government has proposed seven more high-speed rail corridors: Delhi-Varanasi, Varanasi-Patna-Siliguri, Mumbai-Pune, Pune-Hyderabad, Bengaluru-Chennai, Bengaluru-Hyderabad and Chennai-Hyderabad.

“The modern face of Indian Railways that is emerging will benefit many future generations,” Vaishnaw said.

Hundreds of flights

NATS said the fault was traced to its flight processing system and that engineers were working to restore normal operations. “Flights are still departing and airspace is open, but recovery will take some time,” it said.

The disruption led to restrictions on both arrivals and departures across the London flight information region. At Heathrow, departures were paused around lunchtime

before resuming, but incoming aircraft were later restricted as the airport ran short of space. Thirteen Heathrow-bound flights were diverted to airports in the UK and Europe.

Luton, Birmingham, Aberdeen, Glasgow and Edinburgh also reported delays or cancellations. Dublin Airport said flights were affected as well. NATS apologised for the disruption, while airlines advised passengers to check directly for flight updates.

Hockey teams

and caused internal friction within Hockey India. President Dilip Tirkey previously noted the initial change occurred without approval from the executive board.

“IOA asked us about our preference of colour for kit, we gave blue as primary and saffron as the second one. As I had already said before the World Cup that the colour change is not permanent,” Tirkey stated on Tuesday.

Official sources confirmed the Indian Olympic Association designs these tournament kits based on federation preferences. Beyond the jersey decision, the Asian Games remains a crucial tournament for India, offering a direct qualification route to the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

UN map puts AP, Aksai Chin

by India. It shows Arunachal Pradesh without a border with Nagaland and portrays it as a separate region bordering Assam and China. Aksai Chin is similarly shown as a separate region, with its western side bordering India and its eastern side bordering China. The United Nations has not provided an explanation for the changes.

The map also marks the Line of Control (LoC) in Jammu and Kashmir with a dotted line. In a footnote, the UN says the line “represents approximately the LoC in Jammu and Kashmir agreed upon by India and Pakistan.” It adds that “the final status of Jammu and Kashmir has not yet been agreed upon by the parties.”

The map comes after the UN General Assembly last week adopted an African Union-backed resolution titled “Correct the Map”. Championed by Togo on behalf of the African Group, the non-binding resolution calls for more accurate and equitable cartographic representation, particularly of African regions. The map is expected to be adapted as a standard representation by multilateral institutions.

India supported the resolution on the principle of equal-area cartographic representation. The Ministry of External Affairs said the vote “does not constitute endorsement of any specific map, projection, or depiction of national boundaries.”

It also said India’s sovereign territory, including the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, must be shown according to India’s official map, calling inaccurate or misleading depictions unacceptable.

New Delhi has not yet commented on the map’s depiction of Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin. India maintains that Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, including Aksai Chin, are “an integral and inalienable part of India” and has consistently described Arunachal Pradesh as an integral part of Indian territory.

UJJAIN-INDORE METROPOLITAN REGION

One Destination, Infinite Opportunities



MADHYA PRADESH CHARTS A NEW GROWTH MAP

UIMR AT A GLANCE

16,000.87 sq km

Total metropolitan area

6 DISTRICTS

Indore • Ujjain • Dewas
• Dhar • Ratlam • Shajapur

75.34 LAKH

Current population

5 LAKH

Estimated new employment opportunities

38 Tehsils

2,781 Villages



A COMMON VISION, A SHARED FUTURE

Madhya Pradesh is taking a significant step towards integrated regional development with the notification of the Ujjain-Indore Metropolitan Region (UIMR). Conceived as a single planning unit, the initiative seeks to move beyond city-centric development and create a framework in which urban centres, smaller towns, industrial clusters and villages grow together. The metropolitan region will span 16,000.87 sq km, covering Indore, Ujjain, Dewas, Dhar, Ratlam and Shajapur, along with 38 tehsils and 2,781 villages. Its current population is listed at 75.34

lakh, while the plan estimates the creation of five lakh new employment opportunities. The location gives UIMR wider strategic significance. Its eastern boundary will connect with the Bhopal Metropolitan Region, while the western side will extend towards the Delhi-Mumbai Industrial Corridor (DMIC). The framework, aligned with the vision of Viksit Bharat@2047, is intended to encourage balanced and inclusive development across the region rather than concentrating investment and infrastructure in Indore and Ujjain alone.

Unified planning connects cities, industrial centres, smaller towns and villages while opening new avenues for investment, infrastructure and employment

Planning growth together

A central feature of the UIMR model is shared planning while preserving the autonomy of local bodies. A comprehensive master plan for the metropolitan region is proposed to coordinate residential, commercial and industrial development. The framework also gives priority to protecting agricultural land, forests and water bodies and proposes tighter regulation to check illegal colonies and unplanned construction.

Shared infrastructure is another major component. Large facilities such as solid-waste management centres and sewage-

treatment plants could serve several towns, reducing duplication of expenditure and improving utilisation of resources. The plan draws on Indore's cleanliness model for sustainable urban management. For investors, a single integrated authority is proposed to streamline approvals that currently involve agencies such as the Town & Country Planning Department, municipal corporations and the Pollution Control Board. The initiative also envisages improved education, healthcare and infrastructure in smaller towns, with the aim of reducing migration towards major cities.

CORRIDOR BUILT AROUND PARTNERSHIP

The Indore-Pithampur Economic Corridor is a key component of the UIMR vision. On May 3, Chief Minister Dr Mohan Yadav laid the foundation stone at Nainod village for its first phase. The project is envisaged as a 100-km Metro Industrial Economic Zone, connecting Pithampur through Indore-Ujjain with the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway near Garoth.

The first phase comprises a 20-km-long, 75-metre-wide road costing ₹2,365 crore. The corridor will have an overall width of 675 metres, including development extending 300 metres on either side. Under the land-pooling model outlined for the project, farmers from 17 villages will receive back 60 per cent of their developed



land, positioning landowners as partners in the development process rather than simply contributors of land.

LEARNING FROM METROPOLITAN MODELS

The UIMR framework draws inspiration from established metropolitan planning models in India and abroad. The National Capital Region demonstrates coordinated planning across state boundaries, while the Mumbai

Metropolitan Region illustrates how transport links can integrate a large urban region. Bengaluru and Hyderabad are also cited as examples of metropolitan planning and expansion.

Internationally, the plan references Greater London's integrated transport approach, Tokyo's polycentric network and Shanghai's infrastructure-led development. In the UIMR model, different centres are similarly expected to develop distinct strengths – Pithampur in industry, Ujjain in religious tourism and Indore in business. The larger objective is to create a connected metropolitan ecosystem in which infrastructure, employment and investment spread beyond the biggest cities, giving Madhya Pradesh a broader and more balanced platform for its next phase of growth.

New engines beyond big cities

Instead of allowing development to remain concentrated in Indore and Ujjain, UIMR proposes a multi-nodal network. Seven regional cities – Dewas, Dhar, Maksi, Nagda, Shajapur, Sanwer and Mhow – are envisaged as dedicated growth nodes based on their geographical and economic strengths. Tailored development plans are intended to help these centres evolve into economic hubs supporting trade, logistics and industry while strengthening urban-rural connectivity.

Specialised centres will complement this

network. Vikram Udyogpuri in Ujjain is being developed as an anchor city for sectors ranging from heavy engineering and manufacturing to information technology. Ratlam is envisaged as a logistics, multimodal and trade hub, while Pithampur will strengthen its role as a major automobile and manufacturing centre. The broader industrial strategy includes electric vehicles and engineering, logistics and trade, skill development, start-up incubation and four proposed industrial townships.

Where faith, industry and connectivity converge



UIMR brings together Malwa's spiritual heritage, industrial ambitions, green planning and integrated transport to create a new framework for regional growth

Malwa prepares for industrial leap with over 5,00,000 new job opportunities

Industrial development forms another major pillar of UIMR. The plan identifies a 13,500-hectare land bank and the development of 14 new industrial parks, expected to support more than five lakh employment opportunities. Pithampur is entering a new phase as a hub for electric vehicles and advanced engineering manufacturing, while Vikram Udyogpuri in Ujjain is being developed as an anchor for industrial growth. Ratlam is positioned as a

logistics and trade node, and Indore as a start-up and FinTech centre.

The strategy also seeks to connect rural production with industrial and global markets. Around 2,781 villages are envisaged as part of a value chain linking farm-based products with nearby industrial parks. The Delhi-Mumbai Industrial Corridor passing through Ratlam is expected to strengthen logistics infrastructure and improve market access for agricultural as well as industrial products.

An hour can change distances

A defining feature of UIMR's connectivity strategy is the proposed "60-minute access" concept across the metropolitan region. The aim is to enable residents to reach major economic and commercial centres within an hour. The Indore-Ujjain Greenfield Corridor and Indore-Bhopal Expressway are among the major infrastructure projects cited in the plan. The vision extends to public transport, with Metro Rail services proposed towards Ujjain and integration of railway stations, bus terminals and metro stations. A new international airport and Aerocity are also proposed near Indore, with the airport envisaged as a cargo hub.

Skills meet opportunity

The employment strategy extends beyond creating industrial capacity. Educational institutions in Indore and Ujjain are proposed to work more closely with industry, with specialised certification programmes in automobile engineering, FinTech, logistics, data analytics and advanced manufacturing.

Start-up incubation centres are also proposed across the metropolitan region to encourage entrepreneurship. The plan envisages dedicated incentives and employment opportunities for local youth so that economic expansion translates into opportunities for communities within the region.



Growth with a green core

Environmental considerations have been incorporated through a blue-green development policy focused on protecting water bodies and green landscapes. The plan envisages restrictions on construction near the Narmada, other water bodies and forests, along with plantation programmes

MADHYA PRADESH IS ALIGNING INFRASTRUCTURE, LAND USE, INVESTMENT, EDUCATION AND HEALTHCARE UNDER A COORDINATED DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK DESIGNED TO ACCELERATE GROWTH AND IMPROVE URBAN LIVING

and environment-friendly development regulations.

Industrial parks are proposed to use Zero Liquid Discharge systems so untreated industrial wastewater is not released into natural water sources. Large-scale solar and wind projects are also proposed in Agar-Malwa and surrounding districts, with the longer-term objective of developing carbon-neutral industrial clusters.

Planning before pressure builds

UIMR proposes to replace reactive urban expansion with data-driven planning. Geospatial technologies, scientific analysis and predictive tools are intended to forecast development requirements so that roads, water supply, electricity, public transport and civic amenities can precede major urbanisation.

The broader planning framework looks 20 to 50 years ahead, factoring in population growth, traffic, housing, industrial expansion and infrastructure requirements. The objective is to allow smaller towns to develop as specialised economic centres while reducing pressure on Indore and Ujjain – creating a metropolitan region where infrastructure keeps pace with growth rather than following it.



INDUSTRIAL ROADMAP

- » **13,500 hectares:** Land bank
- » **14:** New industrial parks
- » **5 lakh+:** Employment opportunities
- » **2,781:** Villages in the regional value chain
- » **PITHAMPUR**
EVs & advanced engineering
- » **UJJAIN**
Industrial anchor
- » **RATLAM**
Logistics & trade
- » **INDORE**
Start-ups & FinTech

TOURISM AT A GLANCE

- » 5.28 crore visitors to Ujjain in 2023
- » 10% target contribution of tourism to MP's GDP by 2047
- » 4 key destinations in proposed circuit

EDITORIAL

Competence Counts

The Supreme Court’s intervention against the appointment or continuation of teachers who lack statutory qualifications raises a question much larger than the controversy over Assam’s provincialisation policy: who is teaching India’s children, and how seriously does the country treat the quality of those entrusted with its classrooms? The Court has directed that teachers cannot be appointed or absorbed without qualifications prescribed under the Right to Education, NCTE and UGC frameworks. The immediate dispute concerns schemes through which teachers of certain institutions can enter government service, but the underlying principle should apply far beyond one state. Teaching cannot become a profession in which eligibility standards are relaxed whenever governments encounter an administrative or political inconvenience. India rightly demands qualifications from doctors, engineers and lawyers because incompetence carries consequences. An inadequately prepared teacher may cause damage that is less visible but far more enduring, affecting hundreds of children over an entire career. Governments cannot proclaim ambitious learning targets while treating the competence of those delivering education as negotiable.

Yet qualification alone will not solve India’s classroom crisis. The deeper problem is the contradiction between insisting on standards and failing to provide enough properly trained teachers where they are needed. UDISE+ 2025-26 data show more than 1,00,000 single-teacher schools across the country. A recent survey across ten states also found acute shortages in core subjects, particularly mathematics and science, while revealing troubling mismatches between subjects taught and teachers’ academic backgrounds. These are not merely staffing statistics. A school with classrooms, textbooks, digital boards and midday meals but without enough competent teachers remains educationally deficient. Vacancies persist because recruitment is frequently delayed, deployment is irrational, remote postings are difficult to fill and hiring becomes entangled in litigation or political calculation. Governments then reach for temporary arrangements, contractual appointments or retrospective regularisation. What begins as an emergency response gradually becomes a parallel recruitment system. The eventual victims are qualified candidates waiting for transparent selection and, more importantly, children who have no choice over who enters their classroom.

India therefore needs to stop treating teacher recruitment as a periodic vacancy-filling exercise and begin viewing it as the foundation of educational policy. States should maintain transparent, continuously updated vacancy databases, conduct recruitment on predictable calendars and map teachers according to subjects and enrolment rather than political geography. Teacher-training institutions require equally rigorous scrutiny; a degree is meaningless if the institution awarding it provides poor training. The Supreme Court recently reinforced the NCTE’s authority to demand annual performance reports from teacher-education institutions, an important reminder that quality control must begin before a teacher reaches a school. Regular professional development, classroom mentoring and credible assessment must follow recruitment. Most importantly, governments must resist the temptation to use regularisation and absorption as substitutes for open competition. Compassion towards long-serving employees may have a place in public policy, but it cannot override minimum competence or fairness to qualified applicants. India often speaks of its demographic dividend, knowledge economy and global ambitions. All three ultimately begin in a classroom. There can be few more consequential public appointments than deciding who stands at its front.

LETTER

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Building Strength

The approval of Rs 1.10 lakh crore in defence acquisitions is significant, particularly because 98 per cent will come from Indian industry. From helicopters and radars to jammers and mine layers, domestic procurement can strengthen military preparedness while building technological capability, generating skilled employment and reducing dependence on foreign suppliers.

RAJAT SHARMA,
NEW DELHI

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

BRICS in a Fractured World

As India hosts an expanded and increasingly influential BRICS+, New Delhi must navigate internal fractures, geopolitical conflicts and its own delicate relationship with US

GLOBAL PIVOT



DIPANKAR DEY

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OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

India chairs the 18th BRICS+ Summit on 12-13 September, where global leaders Vladimir Putin, Xi Jinping, Masoud Pezeshkian, UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres, and leaders from Brazil, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, the UAE, and Indonesia are expected to gather to discuss this year’s official theme: “Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability”. This year also marks the 25th anniversary of the iconic acronym “BRIC”, which first appeared in a Goldman Sachs economic research report in 2001.

Currently, the 11 official BRICS members represent roughly 49.5 per cent of the world’s population, account for nearly 40 per cent of global GDP, and command around a quarter of global trade. The expanded BRICS+ coalition accounts for over 42 per cent of global crude oil production and controls roughly half of the world’s proven natural gas reserves. In the race towards artificial intelligence, electrification, and renewable

energy, BRICS holds a structural advantage in critical raw materials. China processes over 80 per cent of the world’s rare earth elements and controls the lion’s share of global solar panel, battery, and EV processing pipelines. China’s Cross-Border Interbank Payment System now links 1,800 institutions and had cleared the equivalent of \$245tn in annual yuan transactions by March 2026. Iran’s trade already clears outside the dollar through the yuan and barter. Every time the US Treasury threatens to weaponise the US-controlled SWIFT banking system, it boosts Beijing.

Combined with the 10 partner countries that joined in 2025, BRICS has solidified itself as one of the Global South’s most formidable communities of shared interests.

BRICS emerged in the mid-2000s as a vehicle for emerging economies to secure a greater voice within global financial governance, advocating adjustments to the Bretton Woods institutions, expanded voting rights for developing economies, and a more representative multilateral order. The grouping has continued to prioritise the concerns of developing countries and reduce dependence on developed countries. Institutionally, BRICS has produced tangible outcomes, most notably the New Development Bank (NDB), designed to complement existing international financial institutions.

However, due to heightened geopolitical tensions and the absence of both the Chinese and Russian Presidents during the last Summit, Brazil’s 2025 presidency (17th BRICS Summit) reflected minimal institutional consistency. Trade analysts observe that momentum on economic priorities, such as local currency trade mechanisms and the development of the Contingent Reserve Arrangement, as established dur-



India leads BRICS as old global power structures begin shifting

EXPANSION HAS MADE BRICS STRONGER IN NUMBERS BUT HARDER TO HOLD TOGETHER

ing Russia’s 2024 presidency, notably slowed.

The 18th BRICS Summit is being held at a time when the global order is clearly in transition. Institutions of global political and economic governance are struggling to deliver. Institutions like the UN Security Council, the World Trade Organisation (WTO), and even the World Health Organisation (WHO) are marked by dysfunction and limited effectiveness. Washington’s imposition of sweeping tariffs in 2025, widely regarded as inconsistent with WTO rules, marked a significant departure from established global trade norms. The post-1945 world order has effectively come to an end, and power is no longer concentrated in a single civilisational or geopolitical bloc like the G7.

India’s BRICS presidency, for the fourth time in the grouping’s history, has remained relatively low-key so far. This has coincided with growing difficulties in India-US relations. Under these circumstances, New Delhi is unlikely to champion far-reaching BRICS initiatives that could further irritate Washington, particularly given President Trump’s sceptical view of the grouping and his perception of BRICS as a challenge to US economic and strategic interests. The West Asian crisis has added another layer of complexity. The US-Israeli military action against Iran—an important BRICS member—and the subsequent Iranian retaliatory strikes against the UAE and Saudi Arabia, both fellow BRICS members, have generated fresh political and diplomatic challenges for India’s BRICS presidency.

At the launch of the summit logo in January 2026, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar stated, “India views BRICS as a constructive platform for dialogue and development, complementing the broader multilateral system.” As the group becomes increasingly heterogeneous, New Delhi

has inherited a presidency that confronts several unresolved challenges—mounting tariff pressures, stalled currency diversification mechanisms, an undercapitalised New Development Bank (NDB), and a membership process without defined rules. The criteria for membership are undefined, while the role of partner countries within the bloc remains unclear. Saudi Arabia’s inclusion in BRICS has been the most protracted case. It was officially invited to join in 2023, along with Argentina (which declined the invitation), Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the United Arab Emirates. Though it has not formally accepted the invitation, Saudi Arabia has steadily participated in the bloc’s discussions, including at the Rio Summit in 2025.

The 2026 BRICS Foreign Ministers’ Meeting in New Delhi exposed the growing internal contradictions of an expanded BRICS at a moment of acute geopolitical instability. The clearest indication of these divisions was the inability of BRICS foreign ministers to agree on a full joint statement. In its place emerged a Chair’s Statement. The Iran-UAE divide highlighted a deeper structural contradiction within BRICS expansion. In addition to these challenges, India’s deepening strategic ties with the US and Israel have exposed deep fractures within BRICS, complicating New Delhi’s role as chair of the BRICS Summit.

The BRICS+ bloc of emerging economies has established itself as a viable alternative to the clutch of developed economies—the Group of Seven (G7), led by the US. India must play a leadership role in deciding the future course of BRICS+, with whose members it enjoys millennia-old civilisational connections.

Views expressed are personal

India’s Data Centre Dilemma

Data centres can power India’s AI ambitions, but their resource costs demand scrutiny

TECH IMPERATIVE



RANJAN MUKHERJEE

THE WRITER IS
A SENIOR IAF OFFICER

India’s enthusiasm for data centres comes with a premium. They consume enormous amounts of electricity and precious water and can have a serious environmental impact. There is already considerable backlash against new data centres in parts of the United States, making it legitimate to ask: while data centres are being restricted there, why is India extending a red-carpet welcome with fiscal and non-fiscal incentives, tax benefits, land and easier clearances? Romanticism over data-centre projects without understanding their long-term repercussions would not be in the correct order. But data centres have their merits too, and the economic and strategic reasons behind India’s approach deserve to be weighed carefully.

India is still building its digital and AI infrastructure. It does not want to remain merely a country where sons of the soil become software engineers and build applications for foreign companies. It now wants to capture the physical infrastructure layer too — servers, cloud computing, AI

compute, storage and networking. India’s data-centre capacity has grown from roughly 375 MW in 2020 to around 1,500 MW in 2025. If global companies are willing to spend billions here, bringing investment, technology and infrastructure, there is a strong case for welcoming them. Such investments can also attract AI companies, startups, semiconductor and electronics suppliers, financial services and enterprise-technology businesses, creating an ecosystem around these facilities.

Foreign exchange is another straightforward motivation. Investments in data centres bring foreign capital into infrastructure, fibre networks, servers, renewable-energy generation and maintenance without India having to fund the entire infrastructure itself. There is also intense competition for such investment. Companies can go to Malaysia, Singapore, Indonesia, the Middle East or elsewhere if India does not seize the opportunity. India could then lose billions of dollars in investment, high-value digital infrastructure, AI computing capacity and associated industries.

But the uncomfortable question remains: why should India accept environmental and infrastructure costs that communities elsewhere increasingly resist? Google’s planned \$15-billion AI/data-centre investment in Visakhapatnam has already attracted criticism over land, water and subsidies. India is essentially making a policy calculation that the long-term economic and strategic benefits will outweigh these costs. Whoever controls chips, electricity, data centres, cloud, AI models and networks will command enormous economic and geopolitical power.

The real question, therefore, is not why India wants data centres, but who captures the benefits and who ultimately pays for the infrastructure. India offers rapidly growing AI demand, a huge engineering workforce, rel-



Data centres should become platforms for economic growth

INDIA SHOULD WELCOME GLOBAL DATA-CENTRE INVESTMENT WITHOUT BLINDLY SUBSIDISING ITS RESOURCE CONSUMPTION

atively inexpensive land, expanding renewable-energy capacity, improving fibre connectivity and a massive consumer and enterprise market. At the same time, American data-centre developers are encountering electricity and grid constraints. India can turn this situation into an opportunity — provided it does not simply import the resource costs while exporting the profits.

A better model can be seen in Jamnagar, Gujarat, where Reliance and Meta have signed an MoU and Meta is leasing a 168 MW AI-enabled data centre. The facility is designed around renewable energy with desalinated seawater for cooling, and Meta will cover the energy and water costs supporting its facility. That is a better

proposition than the government providing cheap electricity, subsidised water and land, taxpayers paying for grid upgrades, and the foreign company ultimately taking the computing profits. If foreign companies genuinely pay for the resources and infrastructure they consume, the economics become favourable for India.

There is also a need to be cautious about tax holidays. The 2026 Budget proposes a tax holiday until 2047 for qualifying foreign companies providing global cloud services using Indian data-centre infrastructure. That is difficult to justify without stronger evidence of corresponding benefits. The government may be betting that collecting less tax will bring more investment, infrastructure and economic activity and create an AI ecosystem whose indirect benefits eventually compensate for the sacrificed revenue. But data centres do not necessarily provide large numbers of permanent jobs. A gigantic facility may involve billions of dollars of capital expenditure but, once operational, can be surprisingly automated. The legitimate question is whether such a long tax holiday is justified for that level of employment.

There is, however, an even stronger strategic argument — AI compute sovereignty. Ten years from now, AI could become as fun-

damental as electricity, banking or telecommunications. Depending entirely on computing capacity located outside the country would not be ideal. India needs Indian data, Indian cloud, Indian compute, Indian AI companies and Indian enterprise workloads. Strategically and geopolitically, AI compute is becoming the infrastructure of the future.

The comparison with America should therefore not be oversimplified. The US already has enormous data-centre capacity, leading AI companies, major cloud providers, an advanced semiconductor ecosystem and massive existing AI investment. India has enormous potential demand and a rapidly growing digital economy, but substantially less installed AI compute. The two countries are at different points on the infrastructure curve. India cannot afford to miss the next infrastructure revolution merely because mature markets are encountering constraints.

India should welcome data centres that become platforms for economic growth, but it should not subsidise their consumption blindly. The ideal bargain is simple: foreign companies bring capital and technology; India provides infrastructure and talent; companies pay fairly for electricity, water and grid upgrades; Indian startups, manufacturing and services capture more of the supply chain; and India eventually owns a meaningful part of the AI value chain.

If that happens, data centres can be an enormous win for India. But if India simply offers cheap land, cheap power, subsidised water and long tax holidays while foreign companies capture most of the economic value, the country could end up carrying huge environmental and infrastructure costs without receiving a proportional share of the profits. That is the real issue that needs to be carefully considered.

Views expressed are personal

The Responsibility of Clear Vision

From Sanjaya’s divya drishti to today’s AI-powered dashboards, information has little value unless leaders can distinguish data from wisdom, loyalty from obedience and reassurance from truth

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

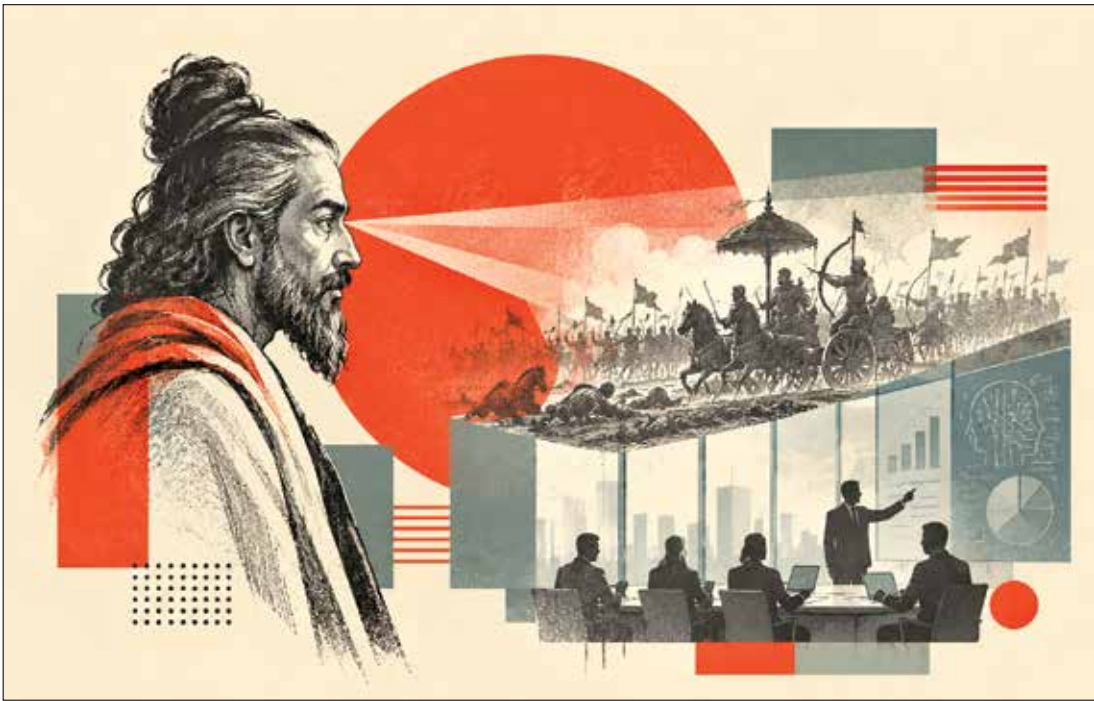
THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON,
BHARAT KI SOCH

How can a leader make the right decision if the information reaching them does not present the full picture? This gap between information and reality can become one of the greatest risks to leadership. Decisions may still be taken with confidence and presentations may still appear reassuring, but once facts are filtered, softened or misunderstood, authority begins operating within an incomplete picture. The Mahabharata offers a remarkable figure through whom to examine this danger. Sanjaya was far more than the narrator of the Kurukshetra war. He was Dhritarashtra’s charioteer, counsellor and trusted emissary. Before the war, he travelled to the Pandavas on the king’s behalf in an effort to avert conflict. Later, Maharishi Vyasa granted him divya drishti, the extraordinary ability to witness the battlefield from afar. Yet Sanjaya’s significance lies not simply in what he could see, but in the discipline with which he understood, interpreted and communicated what he saw.

His story therefore rests on a larger proposition: the possession of knowledge is not power alone. It is a responsibility to see clearly, interpret wisely, speak truthfully and remain sufficiently detached from the outcome to preserve one’s judgement. This responsibility is especially relevant to modern organisations, where senior leaders rarely observe every development firsthand. They depend on others for financial, operational and strategic information. The quality of a leader’s judgement is therefore shaped by the quality of the information that reaches them.

Perhaps the strongest lesson from Sanjaya is that seeing is not the same as understanding. His divya drishti gave him extraordinary sight, but sight alone would have made him merely an observer. Its value came from his ability to recognise the meaning and significance of what unfolded before him. This distinction has become even more important in the age of artificial intelligence. Dashboards provide real-time information; analytics reveal patterns; surveys measure sentiment; forecasts model future outcomes; and AI can process volumes of information beyond individual human capacity. Yet information abundance continues to coexist with poor judgement. Data gives us sight. Wisdom gives us perspective.

A dashboard can reveal falling sales without explaining whether the cause is pricing, customer dissatisfaction, competition or changing behaviour. An algorithm may identify correlation without understanding context. A forecast may estimate what is likely to happen without answering what ought to be done. The challenge for leadership is therefore not simply to acquire more information, but to convert information into understanding and understanding into judgement. Technology can expand our field of



Sanjaya possessed divya drishti, but perhaps his greatest gift was the discipline with which he used it

INFORMATION WITHOUT
INTERPRETATION
CAN PRODUCE
CONFIDENT BUT DEEPLY
FLAWED DECISIONS

vision, but it cannot remove the human responsibility to interpret consequences, question assumptions and exercise discernment. Sanjaya is relevant precisely because his gift was not passive sight. It was sight accompanied by perspective.

The same principle applies to those who carry information upward. The duty of an adviser is to tell a leader what the leader needs to hear, not merely what the leader wants to hear. Sanjaya served Dhritarashtra, yet service did not require him to reinforce every hope or illusion of the king. Traditional accounts repeatedly portray him recognising and communicating the destructive direction in which events were moving. Modern institutions face the same difficulty. Bad news is often diluted as it rises. A missed target becomes a temporary deviation. A failing strategy becomes one requiring only minor adjustment.

The higher a leader rises, the greater the danger that truth reaches them only after passing through layers of fear, ambition and deference. People learn which messages receive approval and which create discomfort. Over time, even without explicit instruction, an organisation can begin editing reality before presenting it to authority. Sanjaya represents an institutional antidote to that danger. Leaders need colleagues who improve the accuracy of their understanding, not merely the comfort of their surroundings.

This leads naturally to another lesson. Loyalty to a person must never become disloyalty to the truth. Sanjaya remained deeply loyal to Dhritarashtra, and his loyalty continued even after the destruction of the war. He later accompanied the ageing king during his withdrawal to forest life. Yet loyalty did not require him to validate Dhritarashtra’s illusions. Modern organisations frequently confuse loyalty with agreement, particularly when disagreement involves someone senior. But genuine loyalty can require precisely the opposite.

A courageous colleague is not necessarily the person who supports every decision. Sometimes it is the person prepared to say respectfully that a decision may harm both the leader and the institution. True loyalty sometimes requires disagreement because commitment to an organisation’s long-term wellbeing must be stronger than the desire for immediate approval. This does not mean that dissent should become habitual opposition. It means that agreement should never be purchased at the cost of judgement.

Sanjaya’s example becomes even more powerful when we consider the emotional conditions in which he performed his duty. Kurukshetra was hardly an emotionally neutral environment. He was reporting death, reversal, catastrophe and ultimately the destruction of Dhritarashtra’s own sons to a father deeply invested in one side of the conflict. Yet his responsibility was to distinguish what was happening from what the king desperately wished were happening. Objectivity matters most when emotions are strongest.

Organisations face their own moments in which emotion threatens judgement: the collapse of an important project, a major financial shock, a public controversy, a failed acquisition, a reputational crisis or conflict among senior colleagues.

Such moments naturally generate fear, defensiveness and attachment to earlier decisions. Yet this is precisely when institutions require more objectivity, not less. When setbacks occur, organisations need people capable of separating explanation from excuse, assumption from evidence and temporary difficulty from structural weakness. Calm assessment is not pessimism. It is a form of institutional responsibility.

There is also an ethical dimension to communication that goes beyond factual accuracy. Information can be technically correct and still create a fundamentally misleading picture. Selective statistics, buried adverse information, carefully framed disclosures or algorithmic outputs presented without proper context may contain individually accurate facts while leading the audience towards an inaccurate conclusion. A board presentation can disclose every required number and still conceal the seriousness of a problem through emphasis and omission.

Sanjaya suggests a higher standard. Ethical communication requires fidelity not merely to individual facts, but to the truth those facts collectively represent. The responsibility of the communicator is therefore not satisfied by being technically defensible. It also requires asking whether the recipient has been given a fair understanding of reality.

At the same time, Sanjaya teaches the important distinction between counsel and control. He could observe, interpret and advise Dhritarashtra, but he could not compel him to choose differently. This remains highly relevant for advisers, specialists and senior colleagues. Integrity requires the courage to advise honestly, while wisdom requires humility about the limits of one’s authority. One must present the strongest judgement possible without assuming that giving advice creates owner-

ship over every final decision.

There is another, less obvious lesson in Sanjaya’s conduct. The messenger must not become the protagonist. Sanjaya witnessed one of the greatest events of his age, yet he does not attempt to place himself at the centre of it. He becomes the medium through which knowledge travels. This is an important lesson for those who advise leadership. Good advisers do not need ownership of every successful decision or public recognition for every contribution. Their value may lie in improving the quality of judgement, asking the question others have missed or ensuring that the decision-maker sees the full picture. Influence need not always announce itself.

Yet even accurate information and sound judgement remain incomplete without moral discernment. Sanjaya’s narration is not merely an account of troop movements and battlefield outcomes. It exists within the Mahabharata’s larger enquiry into dharma, responsibility and human choice. A modern organisation can know exactly what is happening and still fail to ask whether what it is doing is right. The progression therefore should not end with information. It must move from information to understanding, from understanding to judgement, from judgement to dharma, and from dharma to action.

This also leads to perhaps the most sobering lesson. A leader may have a Sanjaya beside him and still remain blind. The presence of truthful advisers, reliable information and clear warnings cannot guarantee wise leadership if authority refuses to accept what it has been shown. Institutions often invest heavily in systems designed to improve decision-making, yet no system can compensate for a leader determined to hear only reassuring conclusions. The responsibility for truth therefore exists on both sides. Advisers must have the courage to speak, but leaders must have the maturity to listen.

Sanjaya possessed divya drishti, but perhaps his greatest gift was the discipline with which he used it. He saw without becoming intoxicated by what he saw, interpreted without manipulating, advised without flattering, remained loyal without surrendering judgement and conveyed painful truths without abandoning compassion. Today, we possess extraordinary tools that allow us to see more than any generation before us, from data and analytics to artificial intelligence. Yet our challenge remains remarkably similar. Can we distinguish information from wisdom, loyalty from obedience, reassurance from truth and knowledge from judgement? The ability to see is a gift. The courage to see clearly is a virtue, and the willingness to convey what one sees truthfully is a responsibility. But ultimately, even the clearest counsel is of little value unless leadership has the wisdom to listen and the courage to act.

Views expressed are personal

Protecting Doctors is a Public Imperative

Stronger laws matter, but safer hospitals require systemic reforms and greater trust; writes Ritik Kumar

The Supreme Court’s sharp observations on attacks against doctors and hospital staff are a timely reminder of a problem India has allowed to become disturbingly familiar. Hearing matters arising from assaults on medical personnel in Maharashtra, the Court stressed that violence against healthcare workers cannot be tolerated and that a strong deterrent message must go out. The immediate principle is beyond dispute: anger over a bill, disagreement with treatment or suspicion of negligence cannot confer a licence to intimidate or assault those providing medical care. Hospitals are places where difficult decisions are routinely made under extraordinary pressure. Turning them into arenas of confrontation imperils doctors, nurses and patients alike. Yet, while swift prosecution and

meaningful punishment are essential, treating violence solely as a law-and-order problem risks addressing its most visible manifestation while leaving many of its causes untouched.

The scale of the underlying problem deserves attention. A recently published survey of 439 doctors practising in India found that 80.2 per cent had experienced or witnessed workplace violence. Verbal abuse was overwhelmingly the most common form, but physical violence was also reported. Emergency departments emerged as particularly vulnerable spaces. More revealingly, doctors surveyed identified mob behaviour and unrealistic expectations about medical outcomes among the major factors contributing to violence. The consequences extend beyond injuries. Healthcare workers who fear being

FEAR SHOULD NEVER
ACCOMPANY DOCTORS
INTO EMERGENCY
ROOMS AND WARDS

attacked can become more defensive in their decisions, reluctant to handle difficult cases and emotionally exhausted. A health system cannot function well when the professional examining a critically ill patient must simultaneously worry about whether an adverse outcome could provoke an assault.

This is why stronger laws, although necessary, cannot constitute the entire response. Much of the tension

inside Indian hospitals develops in an environment already primed for conflict: crowded emergency rooms, long waiting periods, shortages of beds and personnel, expensive treatment and families receiving devastating news while under intense emotional and financial strain. None of these circumstances excuses violence. They do, however, help explain why relatively ordinary disagreements can escalate rapidly. Hospitals must therefore invest in prevention alongside policing. Emergency and critical-care areas require controlled access, trained security personnel and clear protocols for responding to threats. Hospitals also need functioning grievance mechanisms so that relatives who suspect negligence or unfair billing have somewhere credible to turn other than confrontation. Doctors and administrators, meanwhile,

need better institutional support for communicating prognosis, treatment limitations and costs, particularly when outcomes are uncertain.

There is also a larger public-health question. Expectations of medicine often exceed what even the best doctor can deliver. Every death is not evidence of negligence; every complication is not malpractice. Building greater health literacy must therefore accompany efforts to protect medical professionals. At the same time, hospitals cannot demand public trust without transparency, accountability and humane communication. Protecting those who heal ultimately means building a healthcare system in which neither doctors nor patients feel abandoned when things go wrong.

Views expressed are personal

TERROR CONSPIRACY CASE

NIA files chargesheet against Van Dyke, 6 others; UAPA not invoked

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 8

The NIA on Tuesday filed a chargesheet against seven foreign nationals, including US national Matthew Aaron Van Dyke, for illegal entry, stay and movement, but did not invoke the anti-terror law UA(P) A, after arresting them in a terror conspiracy case for alleged links to ethnic armed groups in India.

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) chargesheet, filed before Special Judge Prashant Sharma, accused the seven of offences under sections 21 and 23 of the Immigration and Foreigners Act and said “more time is required to ascertain and verify the true and complete facts about the commission of offences under Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act”.

US national Matthew Aaron Van Dyke had been arrested by the NIA from Kolkata airport, while Ukrainian citizens Petro Hurba, Taras Slyviak and Ivan Sukmanovskiy were arrested from Lucknow airport on March 13.

Three other Ukrainians --Marian Stefankiv, Maksim Honcharuk and Viktor Kaminskyi -- were arrested from Delhi airport the same day. It was alleged that the group was operating as mercenaries.

The NIA had earlier registered the case against them under Sec-



Matthew Aaron Van Dyke

FILE PIC

INSIGHT

» US national Matthew Aaron Van Dyke and six Ukrainian citizens were arrested on March 13

» It was alleged that the group was operating as mercenaries

tion 18 (punishment for conspiracy) of the UA(PA) along with sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS). The chargesheet said, “A substantial part of the further investigation with respect to the offences committed under UA(P) Act, 1967 has been completed.”

“Further investigation is ongoing and more time is required to ascertain and verify the true and complete facts about the commission of offences under UA(PA) in view of import and recovery of huge quantity of drones and acces-

sories through India and seizure of huge number of digital devices whose scrutiny is underway...”

It said that the further probe could “indicate their possible involvement in acts affecting/threatening the unity, integrity, security and sovereignty of India or strike terror in any section of the people of India in a manner affecting India’s interests.”

“Further investigation under 193(9) BNSS may be allowed to be continued in order to unearth all the aspects of the larger conspiracy in the instant case against the arrested accused persons and others in the instant case,” the chargesheet said.

According to the chargesheet, the NIA arrested the accused persons to probe their larger conspiracy in the present case, besides investigating to establish their involvement with the Indian insurgent groups active in

northeastern states.

“During the investigation, it has been revealed that accused Van Dyke and other arrested Ukrainian nationals visited India in December 2025 after obtaining a tourist visa and thereafter crossed the Myanmar border to reach Victoria Camp, Myanmar for providing training to Ethnic Armed Groups (EAGs) of Myanmar,” the chargesheet said.

It said the probe revealed that the accused persons reached India in December 2025 and then travelled to Guwahati on different dates and stayed there in different hotels.

“During investigation, it has been revealed that accused 1 (Dyke) along with other Ukrainian Nationals had planned their movement in India and Myanmar in such a way that it does not seem suspicious to anybody,” the final report said.

It said that the agency’s probe conclusively established that the accused had entered India with valid travel documents, but they did not take any mandatory Protected Area Permit (PAP) to visit Mizoram during the end of December 2025.

Mizoram is a notified ‘Protected Area’ as per the Third Schedule of the Immigration and Foreigners Order of 2025.

The court has posted the matter for further proceedings on October 1.

Indian envoy meets Bangladesh Prez, stresses strengthening bilateral ties

Discussion underscores ‘deep-rooted’ bonds between India and Bangladesh

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 8

Indian High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi on Tuesday met Bangladesh President Mirza Fakhru Islam Alamgir, in his first meeting with the newly elected head of state, and discussed strengthening the “deep-rooted” and multifaceted ties between the two countries.

Alamgir was sworn in as President on August 21.

Trivedi paid a courtesy call on Alamgir at Bangabhaban and conveyed warm greetings to the president, wishing him success in his continued service to the people of Bangladesh, the Indian High Commissioner said in a social media post.

“The discussion underscored the deep-rooted bonds between India



High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi pays a courtesy call on President Mirza Fakhru Islam Alamgir

and Bangladesh, built on shared history, close cultural ties and strong people-to-people relations,” it said.

They emphasised the importance of strengthening the bilateral partnership for the mutual benefit of the peoples of the two countries, the mission said.

Later in the day, Trivedi met Minister of Shipping,

Railways, Road Transport and Bridges Sheikh Rabiul Alam. State Minister for Road, Highways and Railways Habibur Rashid was also present.

During the meeting, the two sides discussed a range of issues of mutual interest relating to railways, shipping, connectivity and bilateral development projects. “They underscored the importance of

strengthening connectivity between India and Bangladesh as a key enabler of economic engagement and closer people-to-people ties,” the mission said in another post.

The meetings come amid efforts by the two neighbours to maintain and strengthen bilateral engagement following a period of strained ties over New Delhi providing political asylum to former prime minister Sheikh Hasina, who fled to India following her ouster in a youth-led agitation in August 2024.

In recent weeks, Trivedi has held a series of meetings with top political leaders of Bangladesh, including Prime Minister Rahman, underlining the need to create a conducive environment to deepen bilateral ties.

IFFJK: J&K CM watches ‘Mirzapur: The Movie’

MPOST BUREAU
Srinagar, September 8

Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Tuesday watched Mirzapur: The Movie at INOX Multiplex, Shrivora, Srinagar, as part of the ongoing International Film Festival Jammu & Kashmir (IFFJK), being held under the theme ‘Rang-e-Cinema’.

The screening gave Abdullah an opportunity to experience the festival alongside film enthusiasts and audiences.

The four-day IFFJK at the Sher-i-Kashmir International Convention Centre has brought together filmmakers, artists and cinema enthusiasts from India and abroad. During his visit, the CM interacted with the film’s lead actors, including Pankaj Tripathi and Divyenndu.

Abdullah felicitated the actors and welcomed them to Jammu and Kashmir, appreciating their contribution to Indian cinema. He said the participation of prominent artistes and filmmakers would strengthen Jammu and Kashmir’s association with cinema and help build a vibrant film ecosystem in the region. The maiden festival is witnessing participation from more than 30 countries, with over 130 films being screened at various venues.

Former CM Farooq Abdullah and senior officials, including Divisional Commissioner Kashmir Anshul Garg and Deputy Commissioner Srinagar Akshay Labroo, were also present.

UP: Moradabad mosque faces demolition threat

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Moradabad, September 8

A mosque in Moradabad is facing the threat of demolition after the Moradabad Development Authority (MDA) issued a 15-day notice to its mutawalli, directing removal of the structure or warning of action under applicable rules.

Located in the Pakbada Police Station area, the mosque stands on around 300 square metres of land that the MDA claims belongs to the government.

The members of the mosque committee maintain that the mosque is old. The development comes amid a controversy in Saharanpur over an old mosque on collectorate premises.

MDA Vice-Chairman Anubhav Singh said illegal construction on government land would not be allowed, irrespective of the nature of the structure.

directed by Mohammad Wali; Arifa, directed by Rohin Ravendran Nair; Batt Koch (The Lost Lane), directed by Siddharth Koul and Ankit Wali; Tasruffdaar (Djinn of Kashmir), directed by Kapil Mattoo; and Naqsh-e-Daur (The Story of Ghulam Nabi Dhar), directed by Baba Tassaduq Hussain.

Searching for the Grandpa follows two siblings in a Kashmiri village during Eid, while Arifa revolves around a woman returning to her ancestral home and confronting memories of her childhood

IFFJK: 5 films picked for J&K Select Section

MPOST BUREAU
Srinagar, September 8

Five films directed by filmmakers from Jammu and Kashmir have been selected for the competitive J&K Select Section of the first International Film Festival of Jammu & Kashmir (IFFJK).

The films were shortlisted on the recommendation of the Preview Committee after reviewing submissions and assessing their artistic merit and suitability for the competition.

The selected films are Searching for the Grandpa,

Saini: Women representatives make democracy more sensitive, inclusive

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 8

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday said women representatives are not merely witnesses to change but its “architects”, asserting that their participation in decision-making makes democracy more sensitive, inclusive and accountable.

Addressing the concluding ceremony of the two-day ‘She Is a Change Maker’ programme organised by the National Commission for Women at Surajkund in Faridabad, Saini said women’s participation ensures that the aspirations of families and society reach the centre of decision-making.

Women MLAs and legislative council members from 20 states and two Union Territories participated in the workshop, which covered legislative procedures, leadership, communication, policy-making, innovation and the role of elected

Hry govt transfers 16 IAS officers

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 8

The Haryana government on Tuesday transferred 16 IAS and 10 HCS officers. Among the IAS officers, Rajeev Ranjan, Principal Secretary, Labour Department, has been given charge of the Fisheries Department as Principal Secretary in addition to his existing duties.

Shekhar Vidyarthi, Commissioner and Secretary, Women and Child Development Department, and Director General, Fire Services, has been appointed Chairman of the State Pollution Control Board, in addition to his present responsibilities. Parth Gupta has been

posted as Director and Special Secretary, Skill Development, besides his existing assignments.

Anmeet P Kumar has been appointed Principal Secretary, Food, Civil Supplies and Consumer Affairs, Future and Sports departments. J Ganesan has been given charge of Citizen Resources Information, Town and Country Planning and Urban Estates departments, besides heading the Haryana AI Development and Clean Air projects. AK Meena has been posted as Commissioner and Secretary, ULBs and Foreign Cooperation departments, while CS Khare will take charge as HAFED MD.

representatives.

Highlighting women’s role, he said a woman MLA carries not only the expectations of her constituency but also the concerns and

aspirations of women. He said Haryana had strengthened women’s participation in Panchayati Raj Institutions by providing 50 per cent representation.

Briefs

Naxal held in J’khand

LATEHAR: A 24-year-old member of banned outfit TSPC, a CPI(Maoist) splinter group, was arrested in Jharkhand’s Latehar district, police said. Rohan Ganju was nabbed during a raid in Barwatoli-Bhagia village. Police said he faces cases of arson in Latehar and Chatra districts and seized a loaded country-made rifle.

J’khand: 2 killed in road mishap

RANCHI: A truck driver and handyman from Bihar were killed after their vehicle fell into a 15-foot-deep ditch in Jharkhand’s Ramgarh district. The accident occurred in Chutupalu Valley after brake failure. The victims, Prabhu Baitha and Vinod Yadav, were from Gopalganj. Police said four people have died in accidents on the stretch in four days.

UP: Fake call centre busted

KANPUR: A fake call centre allegedly targeting debt-ridden UK residents was busted here at Jainmau, with 11 employees detained, police said. Operators posed as debt-resolution agents and allegedly promised victims relief from loans. The centre had been running for two months without registration. A case was registered under BNS provisions.

Punjab govt extends cleanliness campaign

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 8

Punjab Local Government minister Harjot Singh Bains on Tuesday announced the extension of the state-wide ‘Cleanliness Campaign 2.0’ till September 12, citing strong public participation and resolution of more than 83 per cent of civic complaints. He also announced four mega cleanliness drives over the next four Saturdays across all 166 Urban Local Bodies (ULBs).

Launched on August 29, the campaign covers 14 Municipal Corporations and 152 Municipal Councils and Nagar Panchayats. Addressing a press conference, Bains said citizens had lodged 6,459 complaints through the M-Seva app, of which 5,407, or over 83 per cent, had been resolved on the ground.

He said the four mega drives would begin on September 12 and involve NGOs, market associations, youth clubs, reli-

IT COVERS 14 MUNICIPAL CORPORATIONS AND 152 MUNICIPAL COUNCILS AND NAGAR PANCHAYATS

gious organisations and Resident Welfare Associations. He appealed to citizens to spare two to three hours on Saturday mornings to clean parks, markets and neighbourhoods.

Bains said the Local Government Department had also implemented door-to-door garbage collection across cities to prevent the recurrence of Garbage Vulnerable Points (GVPs). He urged residents to retain waste until collection vehicles arrive and warned that littering in public places would attract strict fines after the awareness phase.

The minister said he personally visited Kurali, Kharar and Nangal and witnessed sanitation workers’ efforts.

India steps up care ecosystem as elderly population rises rapidly

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 8

Rapidly growing senior citizen population presents a major challenge and an economic opportunity for India, with the government working to create a comprehensive ecosystem of healthcare, housing, caregiving and other support services for the elderly.

“Senior citizens today constitute a very large section of our country’s population, and the number of senior citizens is increasing very rapidly. At present, their estimated population is around 16-17 crore. Over the next 20-22 years, it is



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

KEY POINTS

- » The govt is working to create a comprehensive ecosystem of healthcare, housing, caregiving and other support services for the elderly
- » Life expectancy has increased significantly and continues to rise every year
- » This makes it necessary to meet the diverse needs of the growing elderly population

likely to double,” said Sudhanshu Pant, Secretary in the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment.

He said life expectancy has increased significantly and continues to rise every year due to improvements in medical facilities and

living standards, making it necessary to meet the diverse needs of the growing elderly population.

“To ensure access to good healthcare, under Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY, free treatment has been provided to all senior cit-

izens aged 70 years and above, with coverage of up to Rs 5 lakh per year,” Pant said.

The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment is operating around 800 care homes for senior citizens across the country

and providing assistance to state governments to run such facilities, he said.

“There is also a proposal under consideration to include provisions for running a day care home in the policy,” Secretary Pant said.

He said various facilities and schemes for senior citizens are being implemented by different departments of the Centre and states, and the ministry has launched the ‘Jeevan’ app to make such facilities available at a single location.

“There is also a need for caregivers who can provide services to elderly people,

particularly in large cities. For this purpose, the ministry has launched an app called Shatayu dashboard for caregivers, which will enable matching between those who need caregivers and those who provide such services,” Pant said.

“Those who require a caregiver can go to the dashboard and find out which caregivers are available in their area and then enter into an arrangement with them,” he added.

The demographic challenge is also creating a sizeable economic opportunity.

According to the ASLI-JLL report, India’s Silver

Economy: From Niche to Necessity, the country’s senior living market could become a USD 10.1 billion opportunity by 2030 under a policy-driven scenario, requiring around USD 7.7 billion in capital investment to meet new supply.

“India’s ageing transition is no longer a distant demographic story - it is unfolding before us. With over 166 million Indians aged over 60 today, a number projected to double by 2050, we need to build the ecosystem for ageing now,” said Rajagopal G, Chairman, Association of Senior Living India (ASLI).

Briefs

‘Use T’gana model for caste census’

MUMBAI: Congress Working Committee member Harish Chaudhary on Tuesday demanded that the Centre include a separate column for Other Backward Classes (OBCs) in its caste census which should be conducted on the lines of the survey carried out in Telangana.

Speaking at a press conference here along with Maharashtra Congress president Harshwardhan Sapkal, Chaudhary alleged that the Union government was moving away from the core objective of the caste census.

AAP claims attack on Goa leader

PANAJI: The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) has claimed its Goa unit working president Gerson Gomes was attacked and injured by an individual, who the Opposition outfit claimed was a BJP worker, inside a village Panchayat office.

The alleged incident took place on Monday in south Goa and police said they were investigating the matter after the AAP filed a complaint.

Goa AAP president Valmiki Naik told media that Gomes was punched and kicked by one Malcom Pereira inside the Chinchinim-Deussa panchayat office.

‘Voter list being manipulated’

PATNA: The Jan Suraj Party on Tuesday alleged that the electoral roll in Bihar was being tinkered with at the behest of the ruling BJP-led NDA ahead of elections to eight seats in the state legislative council.

The allegation was made by the party’s national spokesperson Kumar Surabha at a press conference where those present included state president Manoj Bharti, who, according to the former, will submit a memorandum to the Election Commission.

AFTER A MONTH OF PROTESTS, VERBAL WARS

Kharge purification row: Uttarakhand Police file FIR

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Haldwani, September 8

Police here have registered an FIR in connection with the alleged purification ceremony at the Ramlila Maidan in Haldwani after Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge’s public meeting on August 8, officials said on Tuesday.

According to the police, the FIR was registered against unknown persons under sections 196 and 299 of the BNS as well as Section 3(1)(r) of the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act based on a complaint filed by Congress leader and advocate Anju Arya at the Haldwani Police Station.

The development came a day after the state government assured the Uttarakhand High Court that the matter would be investigated and that all relevant electronic evidence-including CCTV footage related to the incident would be collected and preserved. The High Court disposed of a PIL by a social activist on the issue following the assurance by the state government.

Haldwani police officer Vijay Mehta said that the complaint by Arya alleges caste discrimination, social humiliation and hatred and inferiority towards a person belonging to the scheduled castes.

The alleged ‘purification’ ceremony at the Ram-



Congress leaders leave from Parliament Street police station after registration of an FIR, in New Delhi, Tuesday

PTI

CLOSER LOOK

» Haldwani police officer Vijay Mehta said that the complaint by Arya alleges caste discrimination, social humiliation and hatred and inferiority towards a person belonging to the scheduled castes

» In Delhi, Congress MP Mallu Ravi on Tuesday filed a complaint at Parliament Street police station, seeking registration of an FIR against Shri Ram Dharmarth Seva Nyas president, Girish Chandra Pandey and 15 others over the alleged “purification” ritual

lila Maidan after Kharge’s public meeting on August 8 had sparked an uproar, with the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, demanding registration of an FIR under the SC/ST Act against those responsible. The party also held protests in various parts of the country on the issue.

According to the police, the case will be investigated by Nainital Superintendent of Police (Crime)

Jagdish Chandra.

During the investigation, the police will examine the facts surrounding the incident, the allegations made in the complaint, the available evidence, and the role of the individuals involved, they said.

In Delhi, Congress MP Mallu Ravi on Tuesday filed a complaint at Parliament Street police station, seeking registration of an FIR against Shri Ram Dharmarth Seva Nyas president,

HC refuses to quash 2019 summons to Rahul Gandhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 8

The Bombay High Court on Tuesday refused to quash the summons issued to Congress MP Rahul Gandhi in 2019 by a magistrate court in a complaint over his alleged defamatory comments against Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

A single bench of Justice N R Borkar dismissed Gandhi’s petition against the magistrate court’s order, but extended by six weeks an earlier directive to the lower court to defer hearing on the defamation plaint.

Gandhi, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, sought the extension so that he can file an appeal in the Supreme Court.

Girish Chandra Pandey and 15 others over the alleged “purification” ritual.

Ravi alleged that Pandey and 15 unidentified persons entered into a “criminal conspiracy” and performed a yajna and sprinkled Gangajal at the venue on August 10, two days after Kharge addressed the meeting there on August 8.

Meanwhile, the Congress, Maha Vikas Aghadi and several other outfits took out a ‘Constitution march’ in Latur city on Monday to protest the alleged ‘purification’ ritual carried out after a public meeting addressed by Kharge and the registration of a case against Rahul Gandhi for raising his voice against the act.

The march began after participants paid tributes at a statue of Babasaheb Ambedkar. It culminated in a protest meeting at Mahatma Gandhi Chowk.

Protesters criticised what they described as attempts to undermine the values of the Constitution and create divisions in society, adding that the incident following Kharge’s public meeting was an affront to the principles of equality and social fraternity.

The protesters also condemned the registration of a case against Rahul Gandhi, alleging the action was politically motivated and intended to suppress dissent.

‘FORCED ABDICATION’

Congress slams tribal ministry over stance on Gram Sabha’s consent role

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 8

The Congress on Tuesday termed as “shocking” the alleged shift in the stance of the tribal ministry on the consent role of the Gram Sabha under the Forest Rights Act (FRA), 2006, and said it reflected a serious misunderstanding of the law and an abdication of the Ministry’s statutory responsibility.

The Opposition party said that the Ministry of Tribal Affairs (MoTA) cannot simply distance itself from the operation of the FRA, 2006, as doing so would not only undermine the statutory scheme of the FRA but also make a mockery of the law and of the communities it was enacted to protect.

Congress general secre-

CJP raises seven demands after Satya Niketan building collapse

Seeks independent probe into ‘larger PG mafia’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 8

A day after seven people were killed in the Satya Niketan PG collapse, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) issued a seven-point list of demands, calling for an independent criminal probe into the alleged “larger PG mafia”, accountability of officials and political actors, time-bound structural audits and government hostels for students.

CJP spokesperson Saurav Das said its first demand was an independent criminal investigation into the collapse, which should go beyond the property owner and examine the alleged nexus between owners, politicians and others associated with PG establishments. “The larger PG Mafia needs to be investigated,” Das



A student sits near her belongings as she vacates her PG, in New Delhi, Tuesday

PTI

said in a post on X.

The second demand was for engineering-grade structural audits of buildings housing students, as well as schools and colleges, within a fixed time-frame. The organisation’s third demand was rehabilitation of students affected by the collapse, along with strict enforcement against illegal constructions through sealing and penalties on owners.

The CJP’s fourth demand was a public, searchable database of student accommodation establishments.

As its fifth demand, the organisation called for construction of government hostels for Delhi University and other students, arguing that a long-term solution was needed to the shortage of regulated and safe student accommodation.

The sixth demand related to compensation. The CJP sought up to Rs 1 crore for the families of those who died and Rs 20 lakh for those injured in the collapse.

Its seventh demand was to fix ministerial and official accountability and ensure transparency in the functioning of the 13 district committees constituted following the June 3 Malviya Nagar hotel fire.

NCW ignores substantive issues: Cong

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 8

The Congress on Tuesday accused the National Commission for Women (NCW) of ignoring substantive issues and functioning as a “mouthpiece” of the Modi government, citing irregularities at a two-day workshop for women legislators held in Surajkund on September 7-8.

Congress national spokesperson Ragini Nayak Basoya, Kerala Minister Bindhu Krishna and Chhat-

tisgarh MLA Anila Bhendia raised concerns about the workshop’s structure and content.

Basoya questioned the optics of a women’s empowerment programme inaugurated by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, with five women ministers seated on stage but given no speaking opportunity. “The NCW could not find a single capable woman leader from across the country to inaugurate a programme dedicated to women’s empowerment,”

she asked.

The Congress leaders alleged that discussion on linking delimitation with women’s reservation was discouraged, with women legislators from Kerala facing heckling when they objected. Minister Bindhu Krishna highlighted linguistic discrimination, noting the entire workshop was conducted only in Hindi with no regional-language translation or English materials, marginalising southern and north-eastern representatives.

Man posing as PMO official detained

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 8

A 24-year-old man posing as a PMO official and his armed ‘bodyguard’ were detained at a venue in BKC area here where Prime Minister Narendra Modi is scheduled to attend an event on Tuesday evening, police said.

A firearm was recovered from the so-called bodyguard, said a police official. Claiming to be an official from the Prime Minister’s Office, the 24-year-old man gained entry at the Nita Mukesh Ambani Cultural Centre in Bandra-Kurla Complex (BKC).

The Crime Intelligence Unit (CIU) as well as local police are conducting further probe, the official said, without disclosing the duo’s identity.

HP seeks guidelines for river dredging in flood-hit areas

ASHWANI SHARMA

Shimla, September 8

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Tuesday asked the Centre to facilitate scientific and time-bound dredging of flood-affected river channels stressing that the removal of accumulated debris and sand is crucial to reducing flood risks in the districts vulnerable to disasters.

Sukhu met Union minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav in New Delhi and raised his concern over increased risks of the natural disasters and flash floods.

He unfolded a state

government plan to take-up scientific dredging of the rivers in flood-affected river areas.

The Chief Minister informed the minister that excessive rainfall, floods and flash floods lead to the accumulation of large quantities of debris, boulders, stones and sand in river channels.

This adversely affects their water-carrying capacity and increases the risk of flooding to human settlements, roads, bridges, forests and other critical infrastructure.

The scientific and time-bound dredging in such vulnerable areas is essential from the perspective of disaster risk reduction.

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT, DURG CIRCLE DURG (C.G.)			Durg, Dated: 03.09.2026
<u>e-Procurement Tender Notice</u> (1 st Call)			
Online tenders in form "A" percentage rate basis are invited on behalf of Governor of Chhattisgarh dated 23-09-2026 :-			
NIT No./ System No.	Name of work	P.A.C. (Rs. In lakh.)	
309 / 198850	W.M.M. & B.T. Patch Repair Work Of Various Road Of Bhilai - 03 & Kumhari - 01 Section Under Sub Division No.- 03 Durg	56.77	
310 / 198851	BT. PATCH REPAIR WORK OF SELUD, JAMGAON (R), SECTION NO.- 3 & 4 OF VARIOUS ROAD UNDER PATAN SUB DIVISION	73.57	
311 / 198852	BT. PATCH REPAIR WORK OF JAMGAON (M), HEAD QTR. NO.-1 & SECTION NO.-2 OF VARIOUS ROAD UNDER PATAN SUB DIVISION	48.40	
312 / 198853	B.T.PATCH REPAIR WORK OF VARIOUS ROAD Under Sub-Division No.- 2, Durg	88.99	
313 / 198854	B.T. Patch Repair on Various Road under Sub Div. No. - 1 Durg	55.07	
314 / 198855	B.T. Patch Repair on Various Road under Sub Div. No. - 1 Durg	71.98	
315 / 198856	WMM & B.T. Patch Repair Work Of UNDER SUB DIVISION NO.3 DURG	71.20	
316 / 198857	B.T. Patch Repair of Various Roads at Somni, Surgi & H.Q. No.1 Section under Sub Division No. 1 PWD Rajnandgaon	61.50	
317 / 198858	WMM Patch Repairs Of Roads under Sub Division No 2 PWD Rajnandgaon	76.27	
318 / 198859	B.T. Patch Repair of Various Roads at Ghumka & Tilai Section under Sub Division No. 1 PWD Rajnandgaon	49.20	
319 / 198860	WMM and BT Patch Repairing Work of Bortalav and Chichola Section Under Sub Division Dongargarh	67.75	
320 / 198861	WMM and BT Patch Repairing Work of Verious Road for Head Quarter, Sukuldaihan and Belgaon Section Under Sub Division Dongargarh	80.44	
321 / 198862	B.T. Patch and WMM Patch of under Sub Division No 2 PWD Rajnandgaon (Chhuriya Block)	84.75	
322 / 198863	WMM and B.T. Patch Repair Work in Various Roads (SH,MDR & Village road) under Sub Division Khairagarh	82.79	
323 / 198864	WMM and B.T. Patch Repair Work in Various Roads (SH,MDR & Village road)	63.53	

Note:- 1- General Conditions, detailed NIT, Tender documents & other information of the above construction work downloaded from the Eprocurement web portal or departmental website <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in>

2- NIT No. & Name of the Work should be essentially mentioned on the envelope through the Registered Post/Speed Post in this office.

Superintending Engineer
P.W.D., Durg Circle Durg (C.G.)

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कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, साहेबगंज।
अल्पकालीन ई0-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
ई- निविदा सूचना संख्या – RDD/SD/SAHIBGANJ /04/2026-27
1.कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी:

क्र० सं०/यु प सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	साहेबगंज जिला के प्रखण्ड बरहेट, पंचायत हिरणपुर, ग्राम बरमसिया मांझी टोला और जतरा टोला के बीच नदी पर पुल निर्माण।	221.22527 लाख रुपये	4,43,000/- रुपये	10,000.00 रुपये	15 माह

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 10.09.2026
3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय- दिनांक 10.09.2026 से दिनांक 30.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।
4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, साहेबगंज।
5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 03.10.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे
6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता – कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, साहेबगंज।
7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 9973957543 (संबन्धित कार्यपालक अभियंता का दूरभाष नम्बर)
8. परिमाण विपत्र का तिथि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकृत होगी।
10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुपतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।
11. किसी भी निविदाकार के यंत्र-संयंत्र एवं विद्युत शक्ती के मापदंडों पर प्रत्येक में सक्षम होने पर ही तकनीकी योग्यता पर विचार किया जायेगा।
12. जिस संवेदक का विभाग में पूर्व आवंटित कोई कार्य ललित है अथवा उनका कार्यान्वयन संतोषजनक नहीं रहा है, उन्हें कार्य आवंटन पर विचार नहीं किया जायेगा।
13. किसी भी संवेदक को कार्य आवंटन के उपरान्त सबलेट करना एकरारनामा शर्त का उल्लंघन होगा एवं समुचित सूचना प्राप्त होने पर एकरारनामा रद्द करते हुए संवेदक को काली सूची में डालने की कार्यवाई की जायेगी।
14. किसी भी संवेदक को कार्य आवंटन के क्रम में उनके ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग (ग्राविधि0+मु0मंत्रागशेयो0) के अंतर्गत कुल कार्य मार के आलोक में उपलब्ध यंत्र-संयंत्र एवं वितीय शक्ती की सीमा तक नये कार्य आवंटन पर विचार किया जायेगा।
15. पथ निर्माण विभाग, झारखण्ड, रांची का पत्र संख्या 2146 (S) दिनांक 09.09.2020 में निहित प्राक्कान के आलोक में निविदा की कार्यवाई की जायेगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यलय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,साहेबगंज।
PR 389260 District(26-27)D

News at a glance

UK bans goods from Israeli settlements in the West Bank

LONDON: The UK government said Tuesday that it's banning trade with Israeli settlements in the occupied West Bank, where it says "settler terrorists" are carrying out ethnic cleansing of Palestinians.

Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband said that the UK will ban imports of all goods from the settlements, and some services including financing, construction, infrastructure, real estate and advertising for settlements.

He said that France and Canada would also ban trade in goods from settlements.

Nepal marks first anniversary of Gen Z movement

KATHMANDU: Nepalese ministers, lawmakers, civil society activists and citizens gathered on Tuesday at the old Parliament building in Kathmandu to pay tribute to the victims of last year's violence, marking the first anniversary of the Gen Z movement against corruption that toppled Prime Minister K P Sharma Oli's government.

The government declared a public holiday on Tuesday to mark Gen Z Martyrs' Day, with special programmes being organised across Nepal in honour of those who lost their lives.

Hungary orders 10 Russian diplomats to leave country

BUDAPEST: Hungary has ordered 10 members of Russia's diplomatic mission to leave the country over activities deemed unacceptable for diplomats, Foreign Minister Anita Orban said Tuesday.

Orban did not specify the alleged activities or say how long the Russian personnel had to leave. She said the Russian ambassador had been informed that "according to the assessment of the Hungarian authorities, 10 members of the Russian mission had engaged in activities in Hungary that are unacceptable for diplomats."



People participate in J'Ouvert festivities ahead of the West Indian Day Parade at sunrise on Labor Day in Brooklyn

AP/PTI

US hits Iran's aviation sector with sanctions

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, Sept 8

The Trump administration on Tuesday imposed sanctions on additional elements of Iran's aviation industry, targeting more than two dozen commercial and private airlines as well as foreign cargo service providers in its new push to isolate Tehran from its remaining trading partners.

The latest actions are part of the Trump administration's Operation Economic Outcast campaign that is aimed at severing "critical financial lifelines" for the already heavily sanctioned Iranian government.

TEL AVIV TO CLOSE BRITISH CONSULATE IN JERUSALEM
UK sanctions Israeli settlements in West Bank, condemns 'ethnic cleansing'

ASSOCIATED PRESS
London, September 8

The UK on Tuesday announced sanctions on Israeli settlements in the West Bank, banning the import of goods from the occupied Palestinian territories which it declared as "illegal".

In response, Israel will close the British consulate in Jerusalem, the country's foreign minister said.

UK Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband was joined by Prime Minister Andy Burnham in the House of Commons as he delivered a statement to condemn the "ethnic cleansing of Palestinians"



Representational Image

in West Bank settlements. While highlighting his own "proud British Jew" heritage, Miliband announced a "new comprehensive sanctions regime with appropriate religious exemptions".

"The government

believes the unlawfulness of the occupation should be reflected in the economic relationships we choose to have with the occupied territories," Miliband told MPs.

"So I can announce today that we will introduce

an import ban on goods from illegal settlements in the occupied territories," he said.

Miliband said action would be taken against specific companies and individuals providing construction, infra-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » UK Foreign Secretary Ed Miliband delivered a statement to condemn the "ethnic cleansing of Palestinians"
- » Miliband said action would be taken against specific companies and individuals providing construction, infrastructure, financing or real estate services

structure, financing or real estate services linked to settlement expansion.

He went on to point out the United Nations (UN) definition of ethnic cleansing as a purposeful policy designed by one ethnic or religious group to remove by violent and terror-inspiring means the civilian population of another ethnic or religious group from certain geographic areas.

Nepal flash floods: Death toll climbs to 1,357

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, September 8

The death toll from the devastating flash floods in Nepal rose to 1,357 on Tuesday as more bodies were recovered from the affected areas, authorities said.

Rescue teams continued to search for 5,326 people, while 13,583 people have been rescued so far, the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) said on Tuesday.

The death toll from the devastating flash floods reached 1,357 after more bodies were recovered from different affected areas. The joint command of security forces have recovered 363 bodies from Chitawan district, 223 from Nawalparasi East, 222 from Nawalparasi West and 197 from Nuwakot.

Similarly, 169 bodies were recovered from Rasuwa, 75 from Gorkha, 70 from Dhading and 38 from Tanahu.

So far, 102 bodies have been handed over to the family members after identification and fulfilling due legal formalities, according to NDRRMA.

AROUND 3,500 PEOPLE WERE STAYING IN GOVERNMENT-RUN HOLDING CENTRES ACROSS RASUWA, NUWAKOT AND DHADING

The floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border, sent the Bhotekoshi River raging downstream, washing away homes, vehicles, roads and bridges and damaging hydropower projects across northern and central Nepal.

The disaster also killed at least 43 people on the Chinese side, while more than 500 people remain missing in Tibet, according to Chinese media reports.

Around 3,500 people were staying in government-run holding centres across Rasuwa, Nuwakot and Dhading as of Monday, according to the NDRRMA.

Houthi attacks on Arab ignite fires at oil facilities

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cairo, September 8

The Iranian-backed Houthi rebel group in Yemen launched a wave of attacks on Saudi Arabia on Tuesday, wounding more than 70 people and igniting fires at oil facilities and utilities in the kingdom, authorities

said. The attack was a major escalation in renewed fighting between an important US ally and the Iranian proxy group.

It also threatened to further destabilise a region rocked by nearly three years of wars and deliver a new blow to the global economy.

Eiffel Tower shut for a day over female staff being moved for Hindu visit
India terms it 'private matter' between both entities

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
London/New Delhi, September 8

Senior all-rounder Deepti Sharma on Friday said that India have always been one step ahead of Pakistan in their recent meetings and would look to continue just like that when they face each other in the Women's Asia Cup here on Saturday.

India, who have already made it to the semifinals with one game



in hand, will start as favourites against Pakistan in

their final league game. The Harmanpreet Kaur-

led team is currently on top of Group A with two dominating wins -- against Thailand and Hong Kong.

"Look, there is no advantage as such. The only thing is that whatever we have won against them (Pakistan), whether it is the Asia Cup or any other matches, we are always one step ahead of them. And that's it," Deepti said at the pre-match press conference.

"The whole team is performing well. If you look at the bowling unit or the batting unit, I think both things are balanced. The one who has a good day, she tries to do better and take the game further. And those around her, they try to stay positive things so that they step in more in their game."

Asked about the Pakistan team, she said, "Look, our team is also good and their bowlers are also good. We know that. But we focus more on the strengths we have. And as I said, we want to play a good brand of cricket. That's what we are focusing on. "We just want to play good cricket. As a bowling unit, as a batting unit, the team should be as compact as we are playing in two games."

That's the mindset," said Deepti who has taken six wickets from the two matches so far.

She refused to give out anything on the team combination, saying "That's the call of the management."

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons (1) Indra Devi W/o Lal Chand, (2) Karan Balotia S/o Lal Chand, (3) Joyti D/o Lal Chand, (4) Lal Chand S/o Khem Chand, (5) Koushal @ Gagan S/o Lal Chand, (6) Pooja Balotia D/o Lal Chand, R/o D-492, JJ Colony, Indrapuri, Iari Central, Delhi, have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 125/2016 Dt: 16.02.2016, U/S 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Sultan Puri, Outer Distt., Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused persons cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused persons have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that (1) Indra Devi (2) Karan Balotia (3) Joyti (4) Lal Chand (5) Koushal @ Gagan (6) Pooja Balotia the said accused of FIR No. 125/2016 Dt: 16.02.2016, U/S 498A/406/34 IPC, PS Sultan Puri, Outer Distt., Delhi, are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.10.2026.

By Order
Ms. Neha Goel

Judicial Magistrate First Class
(Mahila Court)-02, North-West,
DP/12696/OD/2026 Court No.-18, Ground Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC/
84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Ravi Kumar S/o Vijay Kumar R/o H.No.419, Gali No.2, Tahirpur Village Delhi GTB Enclave, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case CR Case No. 5056/2023 FIR No.421/2023 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act at PS: Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Ravi Kumar can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Ravi Kumar has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Ravi Kumar of CR Case No.5056/2023 FIR No.421/2023 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act of PS: Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 16.10.2026.

By order
P.Bharghav Rao

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
East District, Court No.03
Karkadooma Courts Delhi
DP/12353/ED/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSONS ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that two accused person namely (1) Deepak @ Lala S/o Shankar R/o H.No. B-478, JJ Colony, Shiv Vihar, Uttam Nagar, Delhi (2) Akash @ Pawa S/o Naresh Kumar R/o D-310, JJ Colony, Shiv Vihar, Uttam Nagar Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 603/2022 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act at P.S. Ranhola, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused (1) Deepak @ Lala (2) Akash @ Pawa cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) Deepak @ Lala (2) Akash @ Pawa have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused (1) Deepak @ Lala (2) Akash @ Pawa of FIR No. 603/2022 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act at P.S.: Ranhola, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.10.2026.

By order
Ankit Karan Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08
West District, Room No.30,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/12231/OD/2026

इसखंड सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, गोडा 814133
(rdsd.godda@gmail.com)

शुद्धि पत्र

इस कार्यालय द्वारा आहूत ई निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या RWD/SD/GODDA/13/2026-27 जिसका पी.आर. संख्या 386906 (Rural Development) 26-27*D है में निम्न प्रकार से संशोधित किया जाता है।

क्रम	पूर्व की तिथि	संशोधित तिथि
1. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	दिनांक 17.08.2026	दिनांक 10.09.2026
2. वेबसाइट में ई निविदा की अंतिम तिथि	दिनांक 05.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक	दिनांक 28.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक
3. वेबसाइट में ई निविदा खोलने की तिथि	दिनांक 07.09.2026 को अपराह्न 2:00 बजे	दिनांक 30.09.2026 को अपराह्न 2:00 बजे

PR 389239 Rural Development(26-27)#D कार्यपालक अभियंता ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, गोडा

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC/
84-Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita,2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Rajesh Kumar (Mob. No. 9313714339) S/o Sh. Chandra Bhan R/o- H. No. 3402, Gali No. 79, B Block, Sant Nagar, Burari, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.104/2019 U/s 279/337 IPC at P.S. Roop Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Rajesh Kumar cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Rajesh Kumar have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Rajesh Kumar of FIR No. 104/2019 U/s 279/337 IPC at P.S.: Roop Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.10.2026.

By order
Rashi Raheja
Judicial Magistrate First Class-13
Central Room No. 33, Ground Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/12686/N/2026

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Specimen Copy of e-Tender Notice for Different Electrical works Open Tender for Electrical (General)

DRM (Electrical)/ECR/Dhanbad for and on behalf of the President of India invites e-Tender for execution of the following works.

e-Tender No. : (EL/16/OPEN/2026-27), Sl. No. : 1. Name of work with location and completion of work : (A) Provision of Maintenance Terminal Console (MTC)/Network Management System for Kyosan make Electronic Interlocking in Dhanbad Division. (B) Provision of Multi Section Digital Axle Counter (MSDAC) in Salaibanwa (SLBN) Yard under Dhanbad Division. (C) Provision of Dog Kennel at DHN. (D) Development of Shunting Track of Jharia Line to Washing Pit from Kalka end in Coaching Depot, Dhanbad. (E) Electrical work in connection with installation of HABD under DHN division. (F) Installation of Rolling - in / out examination lighting arrangement at SVPO, PLBS, BUKRU, BUMH & TORI siding Line. (G) Provision of Gang hut at Churki under ADEN/CPU. (Completion period : 12 Months). Sl. No. : 2. Approx. cost of the work : Rs. 8256672.66/-, Sl. No. : 3. Bid Security to be deposited. : Rs. 165100.00/-, Sl. No. : 4. Bid Evaluation System : Single Packet, Sl. No. : 5. Date & Time for submission of closing and opening of e-Tender : Closing of Bid On 28.09.2026 at 11:00 Hrs. Opening of Bid On 28.09.2026 after 11:30 Hrs. Sl. No. : 6. Website particulars : Website : <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. Manual offers are not allowed against e-Tender. Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (G) East Central Railway, Dhanbad PR/0881/DHM/ELECT/T/26-27/52

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Jogender Singh
Civil Judge (Senior Division) ,
Bhiwani
Nisha
Vs.
GENERAL PUBLIC
CNR No. HRBH02-001975-2026
CIS NO. GW-08-2026
Next Date 09-10-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
GENERAL PUBLIC
~
INDIA
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **09-10-2026 at 10:00 am.** For details logon to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice&district=Bhiwani
Bhiwani
Sd/- Sh. Jogender Singh
Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Dated 03.09-2026 Bhiwani

millenniumpost
CLASSIFIEDS
DATE OF BIRTH CORRECTION
It is for general information that I, Yashoda Devi W/O Mahender Singh D/O Bilochan Singh Rawat R/O House No A-5/24, G/F Kh No_572, Bihari Pur, PO: Dayalpur, DIST: North East Delhi, Delhi - 110094, declare that my Date Of Birth is 21/10/1975 as per my official documents and not 10/08/1977 which may have been mistakenly noted in some document. The actual Date of Birth of mine is 21/10/1975.
CHANGE OF NAME
I, Shafiq Kumar S/o Ramkaran, R/o R.C.-961, Indira Vihar, Near Birbal School Gali No.-07, B Block, Khoda Colony Gaziabad. That my daughter Aadhar Card and Birth Certificate her name mention Nandita and in school record my daughter name mentioned Nandita Gautam. That My daughter correct name is Nandita for all future purposes.



APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the constructive possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 12.10.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 28,09,138/- (Rupees Twenty Eight Lakh Nine Thousand One Hundred Thirty Eight only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLRHN00563592, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 31.08.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 01.09.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from SURENDER KUMAR (CO - BORROWER, HUSBAND AS WELL AS LEGAL HEIR OF LATE LEELEAMMA). The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 27,00,000/- (Rupees Twenty Seven Lakh only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 2,70,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh Seventy Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
ENTIRE BUILT - UP FIRST FLOOR, WITHOUT ROOF / TERRACE RIGHTS OF BUILT - UP FREEHOLD PROPERTY BEARING NO. 280, AREA MEASURING 31.69 SQ. MTRS., IN BLOCK - A, POCKET - 02, WITH SEWERAGE / WATER CONNECTION AND SEPARATE ELECTRICITY CONNECTION, SITUATED IN THE LAYOUT PLAN OF ROHINI RESIDENTIAL SCHEME, DELHI, NEW DELHI - 110085, ALONGWITH PROPORTIONATE FREEHOLD RIGHTS OF LAND UNDERNEATH, ALONGWITH COMMON RIGHTS OF PASSAGE, STAIRS FROM GROUND TO TOP OF THE BUILDING, WITH RIGHTS OF INGRESS, EGRESS & EASEMENT.

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

sd/-
AUTHORIZED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)
Date : 31.08.2026
Place : NEW DELHI

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN U40109TG1977PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)
HOD-Environment, GATP, Goidwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Award of contract on site for Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for CAAQMS at GVKPGSL.
1. Tender Enquiry No. 189/GATP/ENV/50007742
"Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for CAAQMS at GVKPGSL" at 2x270 MW Guru Amaradas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goidwal Sahib, Distt. Taran Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 08/09/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards.
Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
GATP-84/26 PR-Advt. No :- 1079/12/2026-27/14959

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Manjeet Singh @ Batata, S/o: Manohar Singh, R/o: A-159, Chander Vihar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.: 90/2017, U/s: 451/323/506/34 IPC, P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Manjeet Singh @ Batata cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Manjeet Singh @ Batata has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Manjeet Singh @ Batata of P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 09.10.2026.

By Order
Ms. Komal Garg
Ld. JMFC-03, West Distt., Room No. 292,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/12720/OD/2026

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Des Raj S/O Dhani Ram Caste Takhan R/O Kokatreao Pathankot Punjab is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 49/1992 U/S 471/420/467/419/461/415 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids / efforts the accused could not be traced / still absconded.
It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Des Raj
S/O : Dhani Ram
Caste : Takhan
Address : Kokatreao Pathankot Punjab
Age : 65-70 years
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu :0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu :0191-2605949
4.SP City South : 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East : 01912433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133
Sd/-
Superintendent of Police
Jammu
DIP No:DIP/J-9816/26

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 28.09.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 33,09,246/- (Rupees Thirty Three Lakh Nine Thousand Two Hundred Forty Six only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLN000448525, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 31.08.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 01.09.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from VARUN SHARMA and PINKI SHARMA. The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 30,93,244/- (Rupees Thirty Lakh Ninety Three Thousand Two Hundred Forty Four only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 3,09,324/- (Rupees Three Lakh Nine Thousand Three Hundred Twenty Four only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
FLAT NO. SF - 3, M. I. G., HAVING TOTAL COVERED AREA OF 45 SQ. MTRS., SECOND FLOOR, WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, BACK SIDE (LHS), PLOT No. 3/928, SECTOR 3, VASUNDHARA, GHAZIABAD - 201012, UTTAR PRADESH. BOUNDED BY :
EAST : COMMON PASSAGE AND FLAT NO. S. F. 4
WEST : OTHERS PROPERTY
NORTH : PLOT NO. S. F. 2
SOUTH : PLOT NO. 3/929

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

sd/-
AUTHORIZED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)
Date : 31.08.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Daljit Singh S/O Kulbir Singh R/O Ward No. 10, Khem Karan, Tarn Taran, Punjab is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 17/2023 U/S 406 IPC of P/S Channi Himmat, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.
It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Daljit Singh
S/O : Kulbir Singh
Address : Ward No. 10, Khem Karan, Tarn Taran, Punjab
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu :0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu :0191-2605949
4.SP City South : 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East : 01912433778
6.P/S Channi Himmat : 0191-2465164
Sd/-
Superintendent of Police
Jammu
DIP No:DIP/J-9812/26

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, TLM DII PAMPORE, KASHMIR, J&K Power Transmission Corporation Ltd.
NOTICE INVITING e-Bids
E-NIT No. TLM-DII/04 of 2026-27 Dt: 05.09.2026

For and on behalf of Hon'ble Lieutenant Governor of U.T. of Jammu & Kashmir, the Executive Engineer TLM-DII, Pampore hereby invites online e-Tenders valid for 180 days from reputed, competent and financially sound "A" class Electrical contractors/Companies/Firms/Joint Ventures having sufficient experience of the relevant work registered with Electrical Inspectorate of State/UT/ Central Inspectorial organization fulfilling eligibility and qualification requirements as per terms, conditions & technical specifications thereof mentioned in standard bidding document for the work detailed below:-

S No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost (Rs. In Lacs)	Cost of Tender Document (Non-Refundable)	Earnest Money	Time completion
01.	Insertion of Transmission towers at critical locations of 132KV D/C Mirbazar-Lisser Transmission line.	Rs 210.22	Rs. 5500/- The cost of tender documents may be deposited in the form of DD pleaded to Ex. Engineer TLM-DII Pampore & same should be uploaded along with tender documents	2% of Estimated Cost.	180 Days

Submission of e-Bid shall be deemed to have been done after careful study and examination of the procedures, terms & conditions with full understanding of its implications. The tender is available at website <http://jktenders.gov.in>. Interested bidders may view, download the e-Bid, and submit their e-Bid online up to the date and time mentioned in the table below:

A	Date & Time of downloading of Standard Bidding Document	The Standard Bidding Document can be downloaded over http://jktenders.gov.in from 05.09.2026 . /1800 Hour
B	Clarifications start date	09.09.2026 . 1200 Hour
C	Clarifications end date	09.09.2026 . 1600 Hours
D	e-Bid submission (start) date & time (Submission of e-tender fee, EMD in pdf)	09.09.2026 . 1400 Hours
E	e-Bid submission (end) date & Time	25.09.2026 . 1400 Hours
F	Online Commercial and Technical e-Bid opening date & Time	26.09.2026 . 1400 Hours or any other subsequent day convenient to tender opening authority.
G	Online financial e-Bid opening date & time (Only of the technically qualified bidders)	Will be communicated to the Technically Qualified Bidders
H	Venue of opening of e-bid	The Office of Executive Engineer TLM-DII Pampore Kashmir J&K.
I	Head	Capex 2026-27

NO. TLM-DII/ 1810-12
Dated: 05.09.2026
DIP No: DIPF-NB-1567/266
Executive Engineer
TLM DII Pampore,

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE
ICICI Home Finance
Registered Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai- 400051
Corporate Office: ICICI HFC Tower, JB Nagar, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400059
Branch Office: Plot No.19, Sector 12A, Opposite Bal Bharti School, Above ICICI Bank, Dwarka, New Delhi- 110075
Whereas
The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.
As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited.
The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Loan Account Number	Description of property/ Date of Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Ashok Kumar Lohani (Borrower), Ashok Kumar Huf (Co-Borrower), Shiva Lohani (Co-Borrower), B-23/1 3rd Floor B Block B Adarsh Nagar, New Delhi New Delhi Delhi- 110033 Delhi, LHDWA00001585452	Entire Built Up Property Bearing Municipal No. 5/116 (New), and Old Plot No. 282, Khosra No. 458/426, Situated At Old Peshawar Nagar in Village Dheerpur, Presently Known Colony As "Nirankari Colony" Delhi- 110009 With Its Terrace/ Roof Rights Upto Sky High, Consisting With Basement, Stilt For Parking, Upper Ground Floor, First Floor, Second Floor, Third Floor With Terrace/ Roof Rights Along With Lift, Land Area 139 Sq. Yrds. or Say 116.12 Sq. Mtrs. Bounded By- North By : Other's Property No. 5/11, New and Old Plot No. 281, South By : Service Lane/ Gali 10 Ft. East By : Service Lane/ Gali 10 Ft. Wide, West By : Road 40 Ft. Wide./ Date of Possession 03/09/2026	15-04-2026 Rs. 2,91,55,444/-	Dwarka
2.	Ashok Kumar Lohani (Borrower), Ashok Kumar Huf (Co-Borrower), Shiva Lohani (Co-Borrower), B-23/1 3rd Floor B Block B Adarsh Nagar, New Delhi New Delhi Delhi- 110033 Delhi, LHDWA00001585474	Entire Built Up Property Bearing Municipal No. 5/116 (New), and Old Plot No. 282, Khosra No. 458/426, Situated At Old Peshawar Nagar in Village Dheerpur, Presently Known Colony As "Nirankari Colony" Delhi- 110009 With Its Terrace/ Roof Rights Upto Sky High, Consisting With Basement, Stilt For Parking, Upper Ground Floor, First Floor, Second Floor, Third Floor With Terrace/ Roof Rights Along With Lift, Land Area 139 Sq. Yrds. or Say 116.12 Sq. Mtrs. Bounded By- North By : Other's Property No. 5/11, New and Old Plot No. 281, South By : Service Lane/ Gali 10 Ft. East By : Service Lane/ Gali 10 Ft. Wide, West By : Road 40 Ft. Wide./ Date of Possession 03/09/2026	15-04-2026 Rs. 5,80,968,99/-	Dwarka

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/ guarantors(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under the Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.
Date: September 09, 2026
Place: Delhi
Authorized Officer
ICICI Home Finance Company Limited

ICICI Bank
Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Tower, Near Chakli Circle, Old Padra Road, Vadodara, Gujarat, Pin - 390 007
Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra- Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai- 400 051

PUBLIC NOTICE - E-AUCTION OF ASSIGNMENT OF FINANCIAL ASSETS
In terms of the policy of ICICI Bank Limited ("ICICI Bank") on Sale of Financial Assets and in line with the regulatory guidelines, ICICI Bank hereby invites Expression of Interest ("EOI") from interested Scheduled Commercial Banks/ Small Finance Banks/ NBFCs/ FIs/ Other Transferee ("Permitted Transferee") for purchase of "Sixty Five (65)" Non-Performing Assets ("Financial Assets") on the terms and conditions indicated herein subject to "Swiss Challenge Method". It is hereby clarified that confirmation of the name of successful bidder will be subject to the final approval by the competent authority of ICICI Bank.

Base Bid Price	Terms of sale	Minimum Mark up
₹ 400.0 million	100% in Cash	5% of Base bid

Schedule for E-Auction:
Sr. No. Activity Date & Time
1. Submission of Expression of Interest ("EOI") & Execution of Non-Disclosure Agreement ("NDA") (if not already executed with the Bank) From September 09, 2026 to September 22, 2026.
2. Release of Offer Document along with Preliminary Information Memorandum ("PIM") (Post Execution of NDA)
3. Access to data room for due diligence
4. Submission of Bid Form September 23, 2026, by 6.00 P.M.
5. Process of e-bidding (if required) September 24, 2026 from 10:30 A.M. to 11:00 A.M. with auto extension of 5 mins. till sale is completed
6. Right to match by the base bidder, if required September 24, 2026 by 6.00 P.M.
7. Execution of Assignment Agreement September 25, 2026

TERMS & CONDITIONS
1. The auction for the financial Asset(s) is under "Swiss Challenge Method", based on an existing offer in hand, who will have the right to match the highest bid. In case no bid is received which crosses the minimum markup, Base Bid will be designated as the winning bid if it qualifies as per terms and conditions stipulated.
2. The sale of aforesaid Financial Asset(s) is on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "without any recourse basis".
3. Bank reserved the right to withdraw the e-auction, sale of financial assets at any point of time or amend any timelines at its sole discretion.
4. The e-bidding process, if required, will be conducted through M/s e-Procurement Technologies Ltd (Auction tiger) on the website of auction agency i.e. <https://icicibank.auctiontiger.net> as detailed above. The e-bidding process shall be subject to terms & conditions contained in the offer document which will be made available to Parties post execution of NDA.
5. For any further clarifications with regard to data room, terms and conditions of the auction, kindly contact Mr. Kiran Tadge (Mobile no. 9653685873) or Mr. Vijay Kumar (Mobile no. 982803292). For submission of EOI/Bids, email at kiran.tadge@icici.bank.in and vijay.kumar@icici.bank.in or send by post to Mr. Kiran Tadge at ICICI Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra- Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051.
6. ICICI Bank will not be responsible/liable in case of non-receipt of EOI by ICICI Bank for reasons beyond the control of the Bank. Interested Parties are expected to take efforts to find out the status of communication sent by them to ICICI Bank to ensure their participation in the auction process.
7. This notice and contents hereof are subject to any prevailing laws, rules and regulations of India.

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
ICICI Bank Limited
Date: September 09, 2026
Place: Delhi

GODREJ FINANCE
Registered Office at Godrej One, Piroshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai- 400079 Maharashtra
Branch Office: Godrej Capital, R - 5, Green Park, Near Haldiram's, New Delhi- 110016 DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Godrej Finance Limited under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower(s) (the "said Borrower(s)"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice(s) issued to them that are also given below. In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower(s) to pay to Godrej Finance Limited, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest as detailed in the said Demand Notice(s), from the date(s) mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrower(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to Godrej Finance Limited by the said Borrower(s) respectively.

Name of the Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s)/ Loan Account Number	Demand Notice Date, Amount and NPA Date	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1. Mr. Sandeep Singh Nakai 1801, Sector 17, Gurgaon, Haryana, 122001 Also At: Plot No. 2242, Sector B, Pocket 2, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi-110070 2. Mrs. Mandeep Nakai 1801, Sector 17, Gurgaon, Haryana, 122001 Also At: Plot No. 2242, Sector B, Pocket 2, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi-110070 Loan Account No. GFL3101LP0059877	05.09.2026 Rs. 1,94,09,985/- (INR One Crore Ninety Four Lakh Nine Thousand Eight Hundred Eighty Five Only) 4th September 2026	Property bearing Flat bearing No. 2242 on Second and Third Floor with roof right in Pocket -2, Category - III, situated in layout plan of Housing Estate at Vasant Kunj, Sector B, Delhi 110070 under and bounded as:- East: NA West: NA North: NA South: NA

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to Godrej Finance Limited as aforesaid, Godrej Finance Limited shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of Godrej Finance Limited. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the Act or Rules made thereunder, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.
Date: September 09, 2026 Place: Delhi (Authorised Officer) Godrej Finance Limited

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.
Corporate Office: Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra - 400 028
DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL) under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(2) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower(s) (the "said Borrower"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice(s) issued to them that are also given below.
In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower to pay to MHIL, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest at 2% p.m. as detailed in the said Demand Notices, from the dates mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrowers. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to MHIL by the said Borrowers respectively.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s)/ Loan Account No./ Branch	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Date of Demand Notice	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1.	Nareish Sharma/ Kavitha Sharma/ DEL-NHL-000613/ Delhi	Rs. 22,29,694/- Rupees Twenty Two Lakh Twenty Nine Thousand Six Hundred Ninety Four Only	18-Jun-26	All That Piece And Parcel Residential House No. 82/1 Area Measuring 137 Sq. Yards Situated At Nai, Basti Lallapur Tehsil And District Meerut U.P. Boundaries As Per- East- 51.37 Ft Then House of Umesh West- 51.37 Ft Then Sant Kumar North- 24 Ft Then 15 Feet Wide South- 24 Ft Then House of Vinod Sharma.

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to MHIL as aforesaid, MHIL shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of MHIL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made thereunder, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.
Date: September 09, 2026
Place: Meerut
Sd/-Authorized Officer,
Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

CHHATTISGARH STATE RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY
(Dept of Energy, Govt. of Chhattisgarh)
VIP Road (Airport Road), Near Energy Education Park, Raipur (C.G.)
Tel.: 70002-51010 E-mail: credatendercell@gmail.com Web: www.creda.co.in
NIT Ref. No.7433/CREDA/Battery Bank/2026-27 Date: 07.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
CREDA invites online tender for standardization of rates for Supply, Installation, and Commissioning of low maintenance lead acid (L.M.L.A), T-gel & Lithium Ferro Phosphate (LiFePO4) batteries of different capacities with five years onsite warranty conforming to the BIS & MNRE standards anywhere in the state of Chhattisgarh from registered battery vendors (Manufacturer or Dealer/Distributor of Battery manufacturer) of CREDA having experience of supply of batteries with 3 years track record in the field of manufacturing and supply of batteries.

Inspection of Sample : 21.09.2026 at 12:00 PM
Last date of submission of Online Bid : 28.09.2026 till 5:00 PM
Opening of Online Bid : 01.10.2026 01:00 PM onwards

Technical Bid and Price Bid shall be submitted online only at "https://gem.gov.in" Bidders are advised to follow the instructions provided for Registration and e-Submission Process accordingly in the Gem Portal. (For any query about e-bidding please visit user manual at <https://gem.gov.in>.)
Tender document with all terms and conditions is available at www.creda.co.in and at <https://gem.gov.in>
CREDA reserves all rights to accept/reject any or all tenders in full/part without assigning any reasons.
samvad 48977/3 Chief Engineer
CREDA

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.
E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-196 Approx Cost : ₹ 36231037.21
Description of work:Shed of 50 bedded Trainee Hostel for Diesel Training Centre of Diesel Loco Shed Jhansi.
Earnest Money: ₹ 724600.00 Date of closing Tender: 28.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months.
• Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 28.09.2026 . • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.irps.gov.in. 2053/26(AK)
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Pankaj S/o Raj Kumar R/o H.No. B-2/427, B-Block, Yamuna Vihar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 359/2015 U/S 411/34 IPC at P.S. GTB Enclave, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Pankaj cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Pankaj has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said Pankaj accused of FIR No. 359/2015 U/S 411/34 IPC at P.S. GTB Enclave, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.10.2026.
By Order: Ms. Sukriti Jha,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
Room No. 54, Second Floor,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.
DP/12671/SHD/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. 7320262027 Dated: 05.09.2026
E-Tender Notice
Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tender on prescribed form for the following works up to 13:30 hrs. On 25.09.2026. The details of the tenders are as under:
SN: 1 Tender No.: 156 Approx Cost of Work (Rs.): 6,88,82,713.95
Name of work: (a) Extension of new building for class rooms in MDDTI/CNB for Railway Loco Running staff under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB. (b) Electrical work in connection with "Extension of new building for class rooms in MDDTI/CNB for Railway Loco Running staff under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB."
Earnest Money (Rs.): 13,77,700.00 Completion Period: 12 Months
Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: (a) For Building works component: Value of component = Rs. 6,25,77,209.57 Definition of similar work = Construction of Building. (b) For Electrical works component: Value of component = Rs. 63,05,504.38 Definition of similar work = Satisfactory execution of any electrical work related to HT/LT installation.
SN: 2 Tender No.: 157 Approx Cost of Work (Rs.): 3,41,24,642.83
Name of work: Improvement of CETA Hostel and Provision of badminton court hall in CETA hostel under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB.
Earnest Money (Rs.): 6,82,500.00 Completion Period: 10 Months
Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: Construction of Building
Date of Opening of tender: 25.09.2026 for each tender.
Note: 1. Tender on line can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. on 25.09.2026. 2. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.irps.gov.in up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. 25.09.2026 2050/26(K)
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice No. CEN00AGC1026 Date : 07.09.2026
E-Tender Notice
Deputy Chief Engineer (Construction), North Central Railway, Agra Cantt for and on behalf of the President of India invites in TWO PACKET SYSTEM open tender on prescribed forms online (E-Tendering). Tender offer can be submitted online up to 15:00 hours of 30.09.2026, on website <http://www.irps.gov.in>. The details of the tenders are as under:-
Tender No.: E-Tender Notice No. CEN00AGC1026 Validity: 90 days
Description of work: Construction of ROB (End to End) in lieu of Level Crossing No. 358 in Mathura-Achnera section.
Approx Cost (₹) : ₹ 49.65 Cr. (App.) Earnest Money (In ₹) : ₹ 99.30,500/-
Completion Period : 18 Months Date of opening : 30.09.2026
Note: For complete details and submission of tender please see Indian Railway's website <http://www.irps.gov.in>. 2052/26 (MG)
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PULSES AREA INCHES PAST LAST YEAR

Kharif paddy sowing area lags 3.7% amid dip in Karnataka, Telangana

OUR CORRESPONDENT

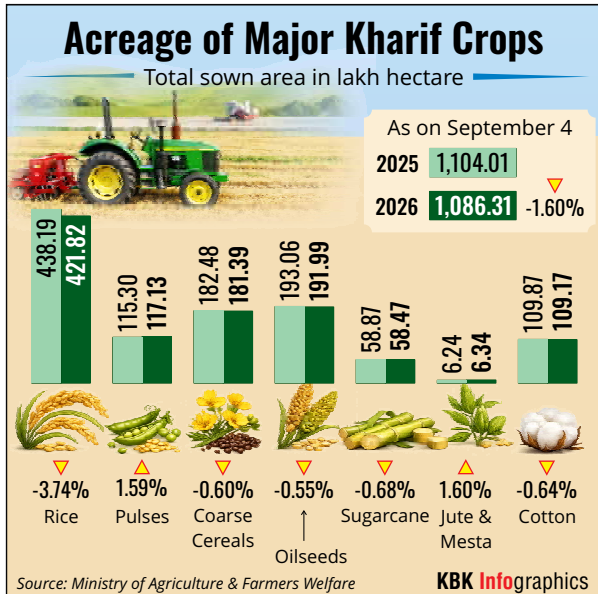
New Delhi, September 8

Total area sown under paddy is running 3.71 per cent lower at 421.82 lakh hectares (ha) so far in the ongoing 2026 kharif season, against 438.19 lakh ha a year ago, mainly on account of lower coverage in Karnataka and Telangana, according to data released by the Agriculture Ministry on Tuesday.

The biggest shortfalls were reported in Karnataka (4.28 lakh ha), Andhra Pradesh (1.91 lakh ha), Telangana (3.61 lakh ha), Jharkhand (1.38 lakh ha), Uttar Pradesh (1.84 lakh ha), Madhya Pradesh (1.75 lakh ha), Tamil Nadu (1.32 lakh ha) and Maharashtra (1.15 lakh ha).

Assam (0.52 lakh ha) and Odisha (0.29 lakh ha), however, posted higher acreage.

Experts said the lag in paddy sowing has narrowed despite fears of an El Nino-hit monsoon, as most rice-growing states



now rely heavily on irrigation, have shifted to short-duration varieties to cope with delayed rains, and continue to benefit from assured government procurement.

Paddy, the principal kharif crop, will be harvested from October. The Centre has set a procurement target of 708.64 lakh

tonnes for paddy grown this kharif season. A marginal dip in coverage is unlikely to be a concern given adequate rice stocks with the government.

PULSES, OILSEEDS IN FOCUS

The bigger worry, however, is the acreage under pulses and oilseeds, for which India depends sig-

KEY POINTS

» Paddy, the principal kharif crop, will be harvested from October. The Centre has set a procurement target of 708.64 lakh tonnes for paddy grown this kharif season

» The bigger worry, however, is the acreage under pulses and oilseeds, for which India depends significantly on imports

» The largest gains in pulses coverage came from Uttar Pradesh (3.97 lakh ha), Jharkhand (0.98 lakh ha) and Telangana (0.90 lakh ha)

from 22.46 lakh ha over the same period. Moong acreage, though, was lower at 33.19 lakh ha.

The largest gains in pulses coverage came from Uttar Pradesh (3.97 lakh ha), Jharkhand (0.98 lakh ha) and Telangana (0.90 lakh ha).

Oilseeds acreage, on the other hand, slipped to 191.99 lakh ha from 193.06 lakh ha a year ago, with soyabean area trailing slightly at 121.82 lh.

CEREALS, COMMERCIAL CROPS

Among cereals, jowar and bajra acreage was marginally higher at 13.58 lakh ha and 64.86 lakh ha, respectively, while maize sowing declined to 91.09 lakh ha. Among commercial crops, cotton acreage held steady at 109.17 lakh ha, while jute/mesta area rose to 6.34 lakh ha.

Overall, the area sown to all kharif crops stood lower at 1,086.31 lakh ha, compared with 1,104 lakh ha in the corresponding period last year.

Modi exhorts fintech sector to expand UPI's global reach

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 8

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday urged the fintech ecosystem to expand the global reach of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), connect it with local systems in other countries, and help the diaspora save on remittance costs.

In his address after the inauguration of the 7th edition of the Global Fintech Fest here, Modi said the UPI platform is now live in 11 countries and has also connected with Singapore's local system.

Urging the ecosystem not to rest on the laurels of the last decade when UPI became a ubiquitous platform for real-time payments across the country, the Prime Minister said the next aim should be to expand UPI's reach.

He said the focus should be on countries that are home to a large diaspora, have high trade volumes with India, or are willing to partner with us while connecting the systems. "This is essential because Indians work in large numbers in foreign countries. They are the largest remitters of



PM Narendra Modi

MODI SAID THE UPI PLATFORM IS NOW LIVE IN 11 COUNTRIES AND HAS ALSO CONNECTED WITH SINGAPORE'S LOCAL SYSTEM

money. A part of the remittances goes away as transaction costs; UPI can help in saving on these costs and the money can also reach families faster," he said.

He said global card payments currently run on systems designed in other countries, but underlined that India now has the alternative on the same.

"We can set our own rules and standards and connect them with the world," Modi said. Reiterating French President Emmanuel Macron's words, the Prime Minister said UPI is not only a tech story but

HIGHLIGHTS

» He said the focus should be on countries that are home to a large diaspora, have high trade volumes with India

» "This is essential because Indians work in large numbers in foreign countries. They are the largest remitters of money"

» A part of remittances goes away as transaction costs; UPI can help in saving on these costs & money can also reach families faster

also a civilizational one.

Modi said that after the high number of successes on the payments front over the last many years, the next chapter for the Indian fintech industry should be non-payment transactions. The Prime Minister also urged the fintech community to develop top-notch cyber-security solutions, ethical data protection standards, and underlined the need for a fintech regulatory ecosystem and a fintech consumer protection index, which can help rate every company on transparency.

Briefs

Rupee falls 18 paise to 94.74/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee fell 18 paise to close at 94.74 against the US dollar on Tuesday as geopolitical tensions in West Asia & rising Brent crude prices nearing \$99/barrel weighed on investor sentiment.

At the interbank forex market, the rupee opened at 94.49 against the US dollar and traded in range of 94.49-94.89.

The rupee finally settled at 94.74, down 18 paise from its previous close.

RBI launches surveys for policy inputs

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank on Tuesday launched three surveys to gauge inflation expectations and consumer confidence and gather monetary policy inputs.

The Inflation Expectations Survey and Urban Consumer Confidence Survey cover 19 cities, while the Rural Consumer Confidence Survey (RCCS) covers rural and semi-urban areas across 31 states/UTs. The next policy review is scheduled for October 7.

India joins US-led initiative to develop secured 6G networks

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Washington, September 8

India has joined the US-led global partnership to accelerate the development of secure 6G wireless networks, the US Department of Commerce said.

The initiative includes countries such as the United Kingdom, Germany and Japan. It intends to help coordinate governments' 6G strategies years before the technology is expected to begin replacing 5G networks in the 2030s.

"Today, we are pleased to announce that India has joined the US and 24 other countries in the effort to ensure that next-genera-

tion networks reflect our shared security interests, strengthen our competitiveness, and drive innovation in 6G," the Department of Commerce said in a post on X on Monday.

US Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick and Minister of State of Commerce Jitin Prasada held discussions on the future of 6G on the sidelines of the G20 Innovation Ministerial in Chapel Hill, North Carolina last week.

"India's joint effort with the United States and 24 other countries to promote innovation and competition in 6G technology will give a new direction to the global digital landscape," Prasada

said in a post on X.

In July, the US government launched the "Call to Action for 6G Leadership and Security," backed by 24 other nations across Europe, the Americas and the Asia-Pacific.

The initiative, led by the Department of Commerce's National Telecommunications and Information Administration (NTIA), seeks to advance the objectives of President Donald Trump's 'Winning the 6G Race' December 2025 Presidential Memorandum.

The Memorandum identified 6G networks as foundational to the US's national security, foreign policy, and economic prosperity.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

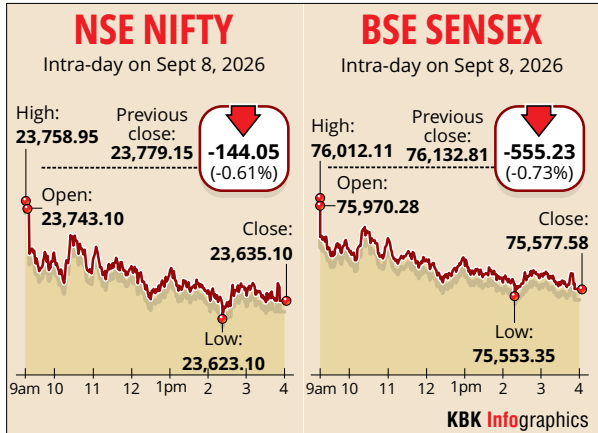
Mumbai, September 8

Stock market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower on Tuesday, extending losses for the second straight day, amid rising crude oil prices and the US-Iran hostilities.

Selling in blue-chip stocks ICICI Bank, HDFC Bank and Reliance Industries also dragged the markets lower.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 555.23 points, or 0.73 per cent, to settle at 75,577.58. The 50-share NSE Nifty ended 144.05 points, or 0.61 per cent, lower at 23,635.10.

Among the 30 Sensex



firms, ICICI Bank, Axis Bank, UltraTech Cement, Kotak Mahindra Bank, Reliance Industries and HDFC Bank were the major laggards.

Bharat Electronics, Adani Ports, Hindustan Unilever and InterGlobe Aviation were the gainers.

The BSE MidCap Select index climbed 0.79 per

cent, while the SmallCap Select index ended flat, down 0.06 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Insurance declined 1.05 per cent, Top 10 Banks 0.97 per cent, Pvt Banks index 0.88 per cent, Financial Services 0.80 per cent, Oil & Gas 0.64 per cent, Bankex 0.63 per cent and Energy 0.48 per cent.

Commodities, Consumer Discretionary, FMCG, Healthcare, Industrials, Telecom, Capital Goods, Power, Services and MidSmall Pvt Banks Quality Tilt were the winners.

FIIIs bought equities worth Rs 280.13 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

LIC to focus on protection, retirement and annuity biz to drive growth: Doraiswamy

ANI NEWS

Mumbai, September 8

Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) will focus on protection, retirement and annuity businesses as key areas of growth over the next few years, while continuing to strengthen its savings and unit-linked insurance products (ULIPs), LIC CEO and MD R Doraiswamy said.

Doraiswamy said LIC's strategy will focus on strengthening its leadership position while becoming a more diverse, technology-enabled and customer-ori-



ented organisation.

"LIC's strategy or focus will both be on strengthening our leadership and remaining as a diverse, technology-enabled and customer-oriented organisation," Doraiswamy said.

He said the insurer expects growth to come from all the segments in

which it currently operates, but will particularly work on increasing the contribution from protection, retirement and annuity businesses.

"Primarily, we are looking at improving the contribution from protection and retirement and annuity business. Apart from retaining our strength in savings and the focus on ULIPs as well," he said. Doraiswamy said the company expects to maintain its growth trajectory in the coming years and continue to remain the market leader.

"So, we should be able

to maintain our growth trajectory in the years to come and remain a market leader continuously," he said.

The increased focus on protection and retirement products comes as India has a large underinsured population and rising awareness about financial planning is creating opportunities for the insurance industry. Doraiswamy said LIC sees significant scope to increase both the number of people covered by insurance and the amount of insurance protection available to those who are already insured.

AGENCIES

New Delhi, September 8

India's real estate sector could raise its contribution to GDP from the current 8-9 per cent to 15-20 per cent by 2047, driven by expansion across residential, office, warehousing, logistics, education & healthcare, Gulam Zia, Senior Executive Director - Research, Advisory, Infrastructure and Valuation, Knight Frank, said on Tuesday.

Speaking on the sidelines of ASSOCHAM's National Conference on Real Estate

CLOSER LOOK

» 'India should aspire to have a real estate sector worth \$8-trillion when the country's GDP reaches \$25-30 trillion'

» 'Affordable housing remains a major challenge, with organised developers increasingly focusing on mid-to-upper and premium segments due to higher margins'

for Viksit Bharat: Enabling Growth, Investment & Ease of Doing Business, Zia said the sector, currently valued at around \$600 billion, could reach \$8-10 trillion as India's GDP expands to \$25-30 trillion.

Affordable housing

remains a major challenge, with organised developers increasingly focusing on mid-to-upper and premium segments due to higher margins, leaving the affordable segment underserved, Zia said.

The office market,

however, remains resilient despite concerns over AI-related job losses, as new technology-driven roles continue to generate demand for skilled professionals and office space. Global capability centres (GCC), along with segments such as warehousing, logistics, education & healthcare, are supporting growth.

Zia expects the sector to grow 9-10 per cent annually over the long term. Residential demand has remained resilient, with around 175,000 apartments

sold across the top eight cities in the first half of the year, broadly similar to the year-ago period.

Zia also flagged shrinking FDI and limited REIT penetration as challenges. Affordability is increasingly a concern in Mumbai, Delhi and Bengaluru, where premiumisation is putting pressure on homebuyers.

He said sustained growth will require continued expansion in premium housing and commercial real estate while addressing affordability and widening access to housing.

'Comm min facilitating export of unique Northeast agri products'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, September 8

The Commerce Ministry has facilitated the export of unique agricultural products from the Northeast such as Tezpur Litchi and Khasi Mandarin to over 15 international destinations like the US & UK in the last four fiscals, helping farmers and exporters access new markets, an official said on Tuesday.

The ministry's measures have opened overseas markets for a range of GI-tagged and other agricultural products from the

region, including Joha Rice, Tezpur Litchi, Khasi Mandarin, Assam Lemon, Karbi Anglong Ginger and Dalle Khursani. Other products which have reached different countries included organic black and green tea, natural honey, ginger, pineapple, anthurium flowers and fresh fruits and vegetables, the official said.

These goods have reached over 15 international destinations, including the US, the UK, Italy, Vietnam, Singapore, Dubai (UAE), Taiwan, Bangladesh, Solomon Islands, Oman, Qatar, Kuwait, Bahrain,

Saudi Arabia, and London.

The ministry's arm Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) has organised 260 capacity-building programmes across the Northeast during the period, benefiting 2,605 stakeholders.

APEDA has also facilitated the establishment of packhouses, laboratories, Centres of Excellence, Trade Facilitation Centres, irradiation facilities, Vapour Heat Treatment (VHT) facilities, and Centres for Perishable Cargo at airports.

News at a glance

TCS bags ₹122.6 crore contract for Odisha govt’s AI platform

NEW DELHI: IT major TCS has won a Rs 122.6 crore contract to implement the next phase of Odisha State Workflow Automation System (OSWAS 3.0), extending its partnership with the state government by about six years. Powered by TCS DigiBOLT, the platform will integrate workflow automation, analytics, security and AI capabilities for paperless governance, enabling digital file processing, electronic approvals and real-time tracking.

OSWAS, launched in 2009, currently supports over 4,600 government offices and nearly 50,000 users across Odisha.

Sun Pharma gets ratings boost on Organon & Co bid

NEW DELHI: Moody’s Ratings and S&P Global Ratings have assigned investment-grade ratings to Sun Pharmaceutical Industries following its proposed \$11.75-billion acquisition of US-based Organon & Co. S&P assigned a preliminary ‘BBB+’ rating, while Moody’s gave ‘Baa1’, with stable outlooks.

Sun’s binding bid involves acquiring 100 per cent of Organon for an enterprise value of \$11.75 billion, with closure expected by March 2027, subject to approvals. Moody’s said Sun has secured a \$12-billion acquisition bridge loan, while cash stood at about \$3.6 billion as of March 31, 2026.

Torrent Power commissions 322 MWp solar projects

NEW DELHI: Torrent Power on Tuesday said its arm Torrent Green Energy has commissioned 322 MWp of decentralised solar projects across 50 locations in Nashik district, Maharashtra, under the Mukhyamantri Saur Krushi Vahini Yojana 2.0.

The projects, spread across 14 talukas, will supply power to Maharashtra State Electricity Distribution Company (MSEDCL) under a 25-year power purchase agreement. The initiative, implemented under Component-C of the PM-KUSUM scheme, aims to provide reliable daytime electricity to farmers, improve grid efficiency and reduce distribution losses.

S&P assigns ‘BBB’ rating to BoI on strong capital, funding

NEW DELHI: S&P Global Ratings on Tuesday assigned Bank of India (BoI) a ‘BBB’ long-term and ‘A-2’ short-term issuer credit rating, citing sufficient capitalisation, solid funding and healthy liquidity.

The agency said the rating is one notch above BoI’s stand-alone credit profile, reflecting the likelihood of extraordinary government support if needed. The stable outlook indicates expectations of adequate capital, funding and liquidity over the next two years.

S&P said BoI’s strong public-sector role, majority government ownership and solid deposits support its creditworthiness.

BRENT FUTURES ROSE OVER 2% TO AROUND \$99/BARREL
India faces higher oil import costs as prices surge on West Asia tensions

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 8

India faces the prospect of a higher oil import bill and renewed inflationary pressure after international crude prices surged on Tuesday, with Brent approaching \$100 a barrel as escalating West Asia tensions raised concerns about disruptions to global supplies.



KEY POINTS

- » It imports over 88% of its crude - raw material for fuels like petrol and diesel
- » A sustained rise in prices raises the country’s import bill & can put pressure on the trade balance and rupee
- » For now, retail fuel prices remain on freeze for over three months. Rates were last revised on May 25

Brent futures rose more than 2 per cent to around \$99 a barrel, while US West Texas Intermediate crude gained almost 3 per cent to about \$94. The latest development followed attacks on Saudi energy infrastructure and heightened tensions involving Iran and the US, raising concerns about further disruption to oil flows.

India, the world’s third-largest oil importing and consuming country, is particularly exposed to swings in international crude prices. It imports over 88 per cent of its crude - raw material for making fuels like petrol and diesel - requirements.

can also feed into domestic inflation through fuel, transport and other energy-related costs, they said, adding that impact on consumers and the wider economy depends in part on how much of the increase is passed through to domestic fuel prices and how long international prices remain elevated.

7.35 a litre and diesel by Rs 7.53 in four instalments.

The increase in crude oil prices will put margin pressure on fuel retailers Indian Oil Corporation (IOC), Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL), who have already been struggling with accumulated losses for not being able to pass on the entire impact of the rise in oil prices in the aftermath of the West Asia crisis.

first five months of the current fiscal and 81.5 million tonnes last year.

The basket of crude oil India imports averaged \$106.26 per barrel on Monday, according to PPAC.

The basket is made up of sweet or low-sulphur (Brent) and sour grades containing more than 0.5 per cent sulphur (Oman & Dubai average) in the ratio 77.81:22.19.

The Indian basket of crude oil breached the \$100 mark, and the September average is \$100.75 per barrel against \$90.19 in August and \$82.04 in July.

Prashant Vasisht, senior vice president and co-group head, Corporate Ratings, Icra Ltd, said, “The renewed hostilities between Iran and the US pose a challenge for the limited crude oil supplies coming through the Strait

of Hormuz. Further, as Iran threatens to establish a new restricted maritime zone extending beyond the Strait of Hormuz, additional energy flows beyond the latter could be at risk”.

Owing to these developments, crude oil prices have increased in the past few days, and the Indian crude basket has crossed the \$100/barrel mark, he said, “As a result of the surge in crude prices, marketing margins on auto fuels are likely to turn negative and domestic LPG under-recoveries could increase from the current Rs 200 per cylinder”.

The disruption comes as traffic through the Strait of Hormuz (SoH), a key route for global energy shipments, has slowed sharply. The waterway normally carries about one-fifth of the world’s daily oil and liquefied natural gas supplies. West Asian oil shipments have fallen to about 11 million barrels a day from roughly 18 million barrels a day amid the conflict.

For India, the effect of higher crude prices extends beyond the import bill. Refiners, fuel distributors, airlines, petrochemical companies and other energy-intensive industries can face higher costs when crude prices rise.

SC junks BDPL appeal, ends three-decade Peerless dispute

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 8

In a significant victory for Peerless General Finance and Investment Company Limited, the Supreme Court on Tuesday declined to interfere with the judgment of the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) and dismissed the appeal filed by Bhagwati Developers Private Limited (BDPL) in a dispute over the transaction of shares.

The dismissal of the plea of BDPL brings to an end one of India’s longest-running corporate disputes, which has continued for more than three decades.

A bench of Justices P S Narasimha and Alok Aradhe dismissed the petition filed by the BDPL and refused to interfere with the April 16 order of the NCLAT.

Senior advocate Harish Salve, assisted by advocates Arunabha Deb and Ashika Daga, represented Peerless while senior advocate Gopal Subramaniam, assisted by advocate Faraz Anees, appeared for BDPL.

The dispute originated in proceedings instituted in 1991 and concerned corporate decisions and share transactions undertaken by Peerless in 1987-88.

At the heart of the dispute were the issuance of 30,000 equity shares by Peerless through private



placement, approved by its shareholders and the board of directors, and the transfer of 15,626 shares by the existing shareholders.

The transactions were subsequently challenged on allegations that they were intended to alter the control of Peerless and involved improper use or routing of funds.

The original proceedings were instituted under Sections 397 and 398 of the Companies Act, 1956. After the original petitioners sought withdrawal of the proceedings, BDPL was subsequently permitted to continue the litigation as the petitioner.

The proceedings thereafter travelled through the Calcutta High Court and the Supreme Court before ultimately reaching the NCLT.

By its order dated July 18, 2022, the NCLT allowed the company petition after more than three decades from the date of the transactions. Peerless challenged that decision before the NCLAT.

On April 16, 2026, the NCLAT allowed the

appeals of Peerless and set aside the judgment of the NCLT.

Upon consideration of the historical corporate records and contemporaneous material, the NCLAT rejected the allegations of financial impropriety and upheld the validity of the corporate decisions and transactions in question.

Thereafter, BDPL challenged the NCLAT judgment before the top court. Peerless has consistently maintained that the transactions were undertaken lawfully, transparently and in the commercial interests of the company, with the requisite corporate approvals.

The conclusion of the proceedings brings finality to a long-running challenge to corporate decisions taken more than three decades ago.

Reacting to the apex court’s order, Jayanta Roy, managing director of Peerless General Finance and Investment Company Limited, said, “After more than three decades, this judgment brings finality to a long chapter in the history of Peerless. We are grateful that the validity of the company’s decisions, taken in good faith and in the interests of the institution, has ultimately been upheld.

“For us, this is not merely the conclusion of a long legal battle; it allows Peerless to look”.

Centre’s ₹37,500 cr scheme to promote coal gasification gets 7 applications in 1st-round

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 8

The Centre’s Rs 37,500 crore scheme to promote surface coal and lignite gasification received seven applications in its first round, including three from Adani Enterprises, the Ministry of Coal said on Tuesday.

Applications were submitted by Adani Enterprises, Gallantt Ispat, NTPC, Shyam Sel & Power and Talcher Fertilisers for projects covering urea,

direct reduced iron, syngas and synthetic natural gas.

Adani Enterprises submitted three applications for urea projects, while Gallantt Ispat proposed a direct reduced iron and syngas project. NTPC applied for a synthetic natural gas project, Shyam Sel & Power for syngas and Talcher Fertilisers for urea.

The first round closed after the application deadline, following the Request for Proposal issued on July 7, 2026. The projects will now undergo detailed eval-

uation under the scheme guidelines and RFP.

The scheme was approved by the Union Cabinet on May 13, 2026, with a total financial outlay of Rs 37,500 crore. It seeks to convert domestic coal and lignite into higher-value products such as syngas, methanol, ammonia, urea and hydrogen, while reducing dependence on imports of LNG, urea, ammonia and methanol.

The government aims to achieve 100 million tonnes of coal gasification capac-

ity by 2030, including 75 million tonnes under the scheme. It expects the initiative to catalyse Rs 2.5-3 lakh crore in investments and create employment across the value chain.

The ministry said the scheme builds on an earlier Rs 8,500 crore scheme approved in January 2024, under which eight gasification projects are under implementation.

Round 2 opens on September 8, with application windows continuing at two-month intervals.

Mega IPO: Jio Platforms set to start investor outreach later this week

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 8

Jio Platforms is set to begin investor outreach later this week after receiving Sebi’s approval for its proposed IPO, which is expected to be India’s biggest public offering at about \$3.8 billion, sources said

Sebi issued its final observations on August 28 after Jio Platforms filed its draft IPO papers in June.

Investor meetings are planned in key global financial centres, including the US, Hong Kong, Singapore



and the UK. According to the draft prospectus, Jio Platforms plans to issue up to 27 crore fresh equity shares, or about 2.9 per cent of its post-issue equity base. The offering could value the company at about \$137 billion. Proceeds will primarily be used to repay or prepay about Rs 27,500

crore of borrowings of Reliance Jio Infocomm, with the remainder for general corporate purposes.

Jio Platforms houses Reliance’s digital businesses, including telecom operations. Its telecom arm has 39.29 per cent of India’s mobile market, with 506 million customers, and 32.89 per cent of the fixed-line market, serving 157.9 million customers.

Reliance Industries owns about 66.4 per cent of Jio Platforms, while Meta and Google together hold about 17.7 per cent.

‘Protein is fundamental component of a healthy population’

‘India’s protein opportunity cannot be driven only by premium or niche products’

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 8

Ranjit Singh, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Food Processing Industries, Government of India, said protein is not simply a nutritional issue but sits at the intersection of nutrition, agriculture, food processing, innovation, sustainability, business and public policy.

“Protein is not a trend, but it is a fundamental component of a healthy and productive population,”

Singh said while addressing the ‘FICCI Symposium on Protein for India: Nutrition, Business, Sustainability and Policy Perspective’.

Singh said India’s protein opportunity cannot be driven only by premium or niche products and called for scalable innovations that reach consumers across income groups and geographies. “The objective should be to develop products that are nutritious, safe, affordable, convenient and accessible, while being relevant

CLOSER LOOK

- » ‘The objective should be to develop products that are nutritious, safe, affordable, convenient and accessible, while being relevant to Indian consumption patterns’
- » ‘Protein can strengthen local enterprises and rural value chains. Innovation must go hand in hand with food safety & quality’

to Indian consumption patterns,” he noted.

Highlighting government initiatives, Singh said the Pradhan Mantri Kisan SAMPADYA Yojana, PLI scheme for food processing industry and PM For-

malization of Micro Food Processing Enterprises Scheme are transforming the sector. He said protein can strengthen local enterprises and rural value chains. “Innovation must go hand in hand with food

safety, quality and scientific evidence,” he emphasised, adding that protein should be viewed as an opportunity to strengthen the entire food processing ecosystem.

On exports, he said investments in processing infrastructure, technology, quality systems, branding & international compliance can help Indian companies move up the value chain. “Protein rich and value-added foods can become an important part of this opportunity,” he added.

Dr Satyen Kumar Panda,

Advisor (Quality Assurance), Additional Charge - Science & Standards & Regulations Division, FSSAI, said improving understanding of protein quality and nutritional value is key. “Let us move the conversation from protein awareness to protein literacy; from individual products to dietary quality,” he added.

Prof Anupa Siddhu, Former Director, Lady Irwin College & Head, Department of Home Science, University of Delhi, said the Indian diet has “too much

of carbs and not enough protein”. She stressed that protein requires “adequate attention but not extra attention.”

Tarun Arora, President, CIFTI-FICCI, said India’s shift towards a higher-income, aspirational economy requires the food conversation to move from food security to nutrition security. The FICCI-ARE report, ‘Charting India’s Protein Transition: Building Resilient Food Systems for a Secure Future’, was also released at the event.

The public issue is likely to remain open on September 18, September 21 and September 22.

There is no official announcement on this issue calendar by the bourse.

The issue, which could raise around Rs 30,000 crore, is set to surpass Hyundai Motor India’s Rs 27,870-crore offering in 2024 to become India’s largest IPO, the sources said.

The IPO will comprise an offer for sale (OFS) of up to 148.9 million equity shares of face value Rs 1 each, representing nearly 6 per cent of NSE’s paid-up equity capital.

There will be no fresh issue of shares, meaning the exchange itself will not receive any proceeds from the offering, they said.

TO FACE ZHENG IN US OPEN QUARTERFINALS

Rybakina overpowers Osaka

ASSOCIATED PRESS
New York, September 8

Elena Rybakina overpowered Naomi Osaka at the U.S. Open and is a win away from the No. 1 ranking in women's tennis.

She just has to beat Zheng Qinwen, which won't be easy. Even when Zheng goes down – way, way down – she refuses to stay there.

Rybakina advanced to the quarterfinals Monday with a 6-1, 6-4 victory over Osaka in a matchup of power-hitting Grand Slam champions. The No. 2-seeded Rybakina is guaranteed to replace Aryna Sabalenka atop the WTA rankings if she reaches the semifinals in Flushing Meadows.

“Of course I want it, I don't know anyone who wouldn't wish this, but definitely that's one of my goals,” Rybakina said. “I try to approach the same way, try to do everything I can, fight until the end my next match and let's see what's going to happen.”

Trying to stop her will be Zheng, who made a daring escape from a 5-0 deficit for the second straight match. The 2024 Olympic gold medalist from China beat No. 8 seed Iga Swiatek 7-5, 6-3 to become the first qualifier to reach the final eight in Flushing Meadows since Emma Raducanu won the title in 2021.

Two days after she was down 5-0 in the third set before winning the final seven games to stun No. 22 Madison Keys 1-6, 7-6 (3), 7-5, Zheng quickly dropped the first five games against



Elena Rybakina in action

Swiatek, the 2022 U.S. Open champion.

“I guess to come back 0-5 yesterday is not lucky, that's all I can say,” Zheng said.

Rybakina won the Australian Open this year for her second major title and her No. 2 ranking is her career best. Even if she loses Wednesday, she can still get to No. 1 if neither Sabalenka, Coco Gauff or Jessica Pegula wins the title.

Rybakina was too good for Osaka, who won two of her four Grand Slam titles at the U.S. Open but appeared to be struggling with a foot or ankle problem. The match lasted just 1 hour, 6 minutes, with Rybakina closing it out with an ace. She leads the

qualifier to win a Grand Slam title in the Open era, which dates to 1968.

Swiatek couldn't convert two set points serving at 5-1 and Zheng fought off another when Swiatek served with a 5-3 lead. She said she was so focused on each point that she even forgot the score.

Swiatek came in with a 7-1 record against Zheng, with the only loss two years ago in the Olympic semifinals in Paris. Zheng came back from a 4-0 deficit in the second set that day to stop Swiatek's 25-match winning streak at Roland Garros, where she has won four French Open titles.

Swiatek got treatment on her left thigh in the second set but said her problems were neither physical nor mental.

“It was more that I started making mistakes from easy balls and Qinwen stopped doing mistakes,” Swiatek said. “She played the balls better.”

Andreeva provides an assist on her way to quarterfinal vs. Gauff-Gauff beat No. 14 Iva Jovic 6-1, 6-4 to return to the U.S. Open quarterfinals for the first time since winning her first major title at the tournament in 2023. She lost in the fourth round in each of the last two years.

The No. 4 seed will face French Open champion Mirra Andreeva, the No. 5 seed who came back to beat No. 24 Anastasia Potapova 5-7, 6-4, 6-3, after helping her opponent when she injured her knee in the final game of the match.

RYBAKINA WON THE AUSTRALIAN OPEN THIS YEAR FOR HER 2ND MAJOR TITLE AND HER NO. 2 RANKING IS HER CAREER BEST

WTA Tour in that category.

Resurgent Zheng goes from qualifying to quarterfinalsZheng was a U.S. Open quarterfinalist in 2023 and 2024 – the year she reached the Australian Open final – but after her ranked dropped following elbow surgery she had to go through qualifying this year to reach the main draw.

Raducanu's title five years ago made her the first

Indian women's hockey team departs for Asian Games

Eyes gold and direct qualification for LA 2028

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Bengaluru, September 8

Fresh from a historic fifth-place finish at the World Cup, the Indian women's hockey team on Tuesday departed for the Asian Games in Japan, with their sights firmly set on winning the gold medal and securing a direct berth at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympic Games.

Led by captain Salima Tete and coached by Sjoerd Marijne, India produced one of its finest performances in decades as the team finished fifth, its best World Cup result since the inaugural edition in 1974.

The attention now shifts



to the Asian Games, where the stakes are even higher.

Under the FIH's LA 2028 qualification system, the highest-placed eligible team in the women's hockey competition at the Asian Games will earn an Olympic quota place, provided it has not already qualified through

another pathway.

“We are going into the Asian Games with a lot of confidence, but we also know that every tournament brings a new challenge,” said Tete, who has led India to the Nations Cup title and the historic World Cup fifth-place finish this year, in a release.

Ponting worried about future of ODI

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 8

Legendary Ricky Ponting is worried that the One day cricket could slowly lose its place in an increasingly choc-a-bloc calendar, with T20 Internationals and franchise leagues continuing their expansion across the globe.

Ponting fears ODI cricket will be played “less and less” in the coming years as more T20 leagues emerge, even though he remains convinced that Test cricket will continue to thrive as long as major cricketing nations remain invested in it.

“As the months go by and the years go by and



Australia Champions franchise owners Puneet Singh and Ricky Ponting along with team Captain David Warner

more and more T20 cricket is being played and more franchises and franchise tournaments are starting around the world, it's more and more likely that 50-over cricket is probably

going to be played less. It's inevitable, which I'm not a huge fan of, to be honest,” Ponting told PTI in an exclusive interaction.

The former Australia captain was speak-

ing during an interaction facilitated by the World Championship of Legends, where he will be a co-owner of the Australia Champions franchise.

Ponting, who scored 13,704 runs in ODIs, feels ‘Big Four’ including South Africa, India, Australia and England will keep Test cricket in a healthy state.

“I love playing that format of the game, but something's got to give somewhere. Test cricket is still going to remain strong as long as India, Australia, England and probably South Africa want Test cricket to remain strong. It will. So something's got to give. And the obvious one is 50-over cricket,” he said.

FILM

DAWAT-E-DILLI

Bringing flavours of Purani Dilli to Gurugram

OUR CORRESPONDENT

This September, Gurugram is set to embark on a delicious journey through the lanes, aromas and iconic flavours of Old Delhi with ‘Dawat-e-Dilli’, a special culinary festival at Holiday Inn Gurugram Sector 90. To be held till September 13, from 7 pm to 11 pm, Executive Chef Prakash Yadav will bring the charm and rich culinary heritage of Purani Dilli to the city, recreating some of its most beloved street food.

Inspired by the bustling streets and timeless food culture of Old Delhi, ‘Dawat-e-Dilli’ promises an indulgent experience that goes beyond the plate. The restaurant will be transformed into a themed décor inspired by the vibrant character of Purani Dilli, while themed music will set the mood, transporting guests into the heart of the old city as they dine. From the aromas of slow-cooked Mughlai delicacies to the lively spirit of Delhi's famous food lanes, every element will come together to create an immersive culinary experience.

Guests can savour a selection of Old Delhi favourites including Nihari, Mutton Korma, Shami Kebab, Chicken Tikka and Butter Chicken. The vegetarian spread brings together much-loved classics such as Kulchas, Kachoris, Stuffed Parathas and Chole Bhature.



THE FOOD FESTIVAL PROMISES AN INDULGENT EXPERIENCE THAT GOES BEYOND THE PLATE

No Delhi food trail would be complete without its legendary chaat. The festival will feature Papdi Chaat, Dahi Bhalla, Gol Gappe, Aloo Tikki and Fruit Chaat, offering guests a vibrant taste of the city's iconic street-food culture.

The experience culminates on a sweet note with traditional favourites including Daulat Ki Chaat, Shahi Tukda, Jalebi Rabri and Kadai Wala Doodh Jalebi.

Executive Chef Prakash Yadav said, “Purani Dilli is not just a place; it's an emotion expressed through food. Every dish has a story, from the slow-cooked richness of Nihari and Mutton Korma to the lively flavours of chaat and the nostalgia of jalebi with ‘rabri’. With ‘Dawat-e-Dilli’, we aim to bring the spirit of those bustling streets to Gurugram and give our guests an experience that feels both authentic and nostalgic. It is a celebration of the food, memories and traditions that make Dilli truly special.”

Bipasha dismisses facing trolling

‘I like myself more at 47 than I did in my 20s,’ says Basu

Bipasha Basu was trolled brutally for postpartum weight gain after welcoming her daughter, Devi, with her husband, actor Karan Singh Grover. In a recent comeback interview with ‘Elle India’, she opened up about ‘ignoring’ the noise of harsh body-shaming on social media. The actress, 47, is ready to return to acting and expressed feeling comfortable with the process of ageing. Bipasha admitted liking her body more now, which is what she used to be in her 20s.

Basu, who built her reputation as one of Bollywood's earliest fitness icons, revealed that the post-pregnancy trolling didn't bother her much. “I'm an extremely confi-

dent person, so no kind of trolling can break me. I know what my journey is, I know what work I need to put in, when I need to put it in and I'll go with that. Outside noise does not really matter. The choice of profession that I have made means my life is open to judgement and criticism at all points in time.”

She further added, “Very early in life, I understood what I need to accept and what I need to cut off. There's a lot of noise and especially now with social media, everyone can critique you. So, it's very important that you are really confident within yourself, in your life, in your space and you actually love yourself and like the things that you do.

I don't know if that makes me cool or not, but this is the only way I know.”

The same goes for her age. In her 40s, she doesn't feel the pressure to look a certain way. “I believe that I like myself more, the person that I am today, much more than what I used to be in my 20s. What other people are doing, it's their call. I don't judge that. But for me, I'm never going to fall into the pressure of wanting to look younger than what I am. I'm very happy with the way I am growing older and I'm very proud of my age,” she expressed.

AGENCIES



Ellen Burstyn honoured at VIFF 2026

The veteran actress was felicitated with the Golden Lion for Lifetime Achievement award

Hollywood actress Ellen Burstyn received the Golden Lion for Lifetime Achievement award at the Venice International Film Festival.

The award honours individuals who have made extraordinary contributions to cinema. She was awarded on Monday at

AT THE EVENT, HER FILM ‘FLESH IMPACT’ WAS ALSO SCREENED

the Lido di Venezia, according to the entertainment news outlet ‘Deadline’.

The actress, 93, is known for her roles in films such as ‘The Exorcist’, ‘Mrs Harris’, ‘House of Cards’ and others. She has also achieved the ‘Triple Crown of Acting’ in her career by winning an Academy Award, a Tony Award, and multiple Emmy Awards.

At the event, her film ‘Flesh Impact’ was also screened. It's directed by Maggie Gyllenhaal and imagines an alternate reality where Marilyn Monroe lived to be 100 years old.

The festival started on September 2 and concluded on September 12.

PTI